Chimera user guide

Video-generation and fit-to-scene instructions and the PDF edition were updated on 2026-11-03. Synthesia/Shotstack setup images below are historical October 27 captures; follow the current text for generation. Local verification uses synthetic provider replies, not paid renders or live-account qualification.

Process-based instructions for Chimera. Shape/appearance/layer and timeline instructions and the PDF edition were refreshed on 2026-10-28; the timeline capture manifest records the synthetic fixtures and source/image/PDF hashes. Earlier workflow text and the PDF edition were refreshed on 2026-10-27 for one authored scene across Stage, storyboard, preview, and delivery; temporary original comparison; direct template application with Undo/Redo; project background import and inheritance; and presentation-first preview navigation. The authored-scene manifest records the current captures and implementation hashes. Earlier October 27 assessment/navigation and provider captures remain current where their controls are unchanged. Provider images use inert status/capability fixtures, not configured accounts or generated output. Other images retain their earlier provenance in the maintenance guide. No user course or credentials are used for captures. Historical source/recovery context remains in the recovery record.

Chimera authors one scene. Edit its content and composition, inherit project defaults unless you deliberately create an exception, and choose a destination when exporting. The authored-scene workflow explains migration and output behavior; the steps below show the controls.

How to use this guide

Tasks use numbered instructions or **Step / Action / Result / Control image** tables. Click a control image to open the full-size screenshot. Screenshots show the real Chimera interface in Light appearance, using an isolated demonstration project. Course names and sample content will differ in your workspace. Browser file pickers, download prompts, and confirmation dialogs vary by browser and operating system; screenshots show the Chimera controls that open them. Follow the current text labels where an older image differs.

The source has changed since the original capability review: Word export, reference upload, enhancement submission, generated-media candidate review, comments, and Chimera storyboard archives now have interface controls. Their presence does not certify a configured AI provider or compatibility with every LMS. Example proposals, candidates, and job statuses in these images are documentation fixtures; no live AI request was made for this guide.

Prerequisite: Start the backend and frontend using the README setup instructions, then open `http://localhost:5173`. Keep both services running while authoring. LibreOffice is needed for rendered PowerPoint slide previews. Pythia workflows additionally need the Engine API; check **Settings > Pythia**. Image and narration generation use the separate **Settings > AI connection** dialog. Shared-installation connection changes require an administrator; see AI connection.

Help while authoring: choose **User guide**, immediately below **Templates** in the left rail. The bundled PDF opens in a new tab without leaving your current workspace or discarding edits. It is available even before you select or create a project and does not require access to GitHub.

Navigation at a glance: the left rail's **WORKSPACE** group contains My Work, Storyboard, Assessments, Media library, and Templates. **Assessments** opens the question bank and assessment manager directly. **Project background** is above the scene list in **Storyboard**. Review tools retains guided review, accessibility, validation, completion rules, and suggestion/Pythia review; Settings retains appearance and connection/access controls.

My Work opens after normal launch/sign-in and refresh. It is first in the workspace menu. Select a project row to open its authoring workspace, choose New Project to create one, or Resume authoring to return to the remembered project. Direct authenticated review links retain their review destination.

Working convention: Select the intended project and scene before editing. Use the task's Save/Create/Accept control and wait for completion. Merely typing into a form does not save it. If a revision-conflict message appears, reload the project, inspect the latest values, and reapply the intended change. Do not assume unsaved form text will survive a reload.

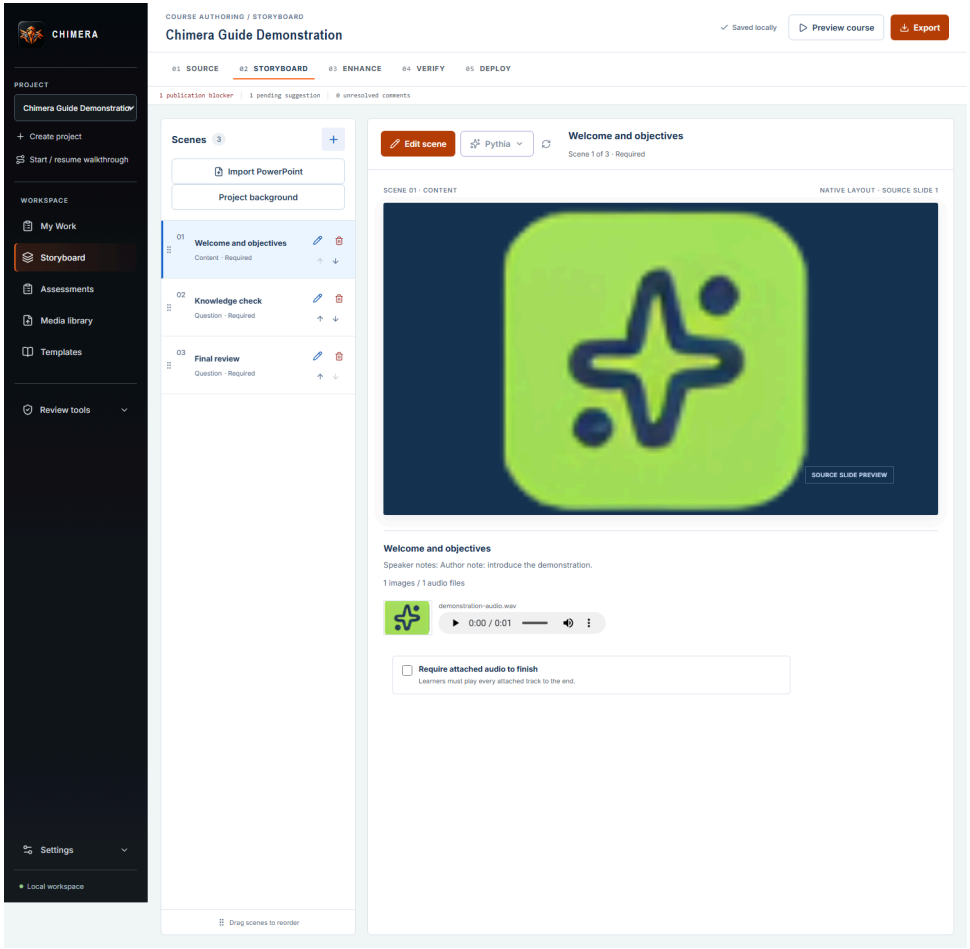
Optional interactive help is available under **Review tools > Guided review > All functionality walkthroughs**. Search the 68-task catalog, including nine Pythia workflows, and start the task you want to practice. **Start / resume walkthrough** uses your current workflow when one is identifiable; Storyboard and the catalog retain the last selected task. Supported dialogs offer **Start walkthrough** for their current task, or **Resume walkthrough** only when the paused guide matches that workflow. They do not resume an unrelated first-scene guide. In a newly guided scene editor, Stage selects canvas authoring and Details selects scene editing; the question editor uses the current Question type. An explicitly selected catalog task retains its own instructions. Action steps wait for confirmed saves/downloads; Pythia draft steps wait until the draft is saved in Chimera, and review steps use Next. Escape pauses without clearing an open draft. Progress is browser-local and separate for each task/project; completing a walkthrough does not certify readiness. Restore/deletion confirmations and provider submissions remain your decisions. See context-aware start and resume for limits.

Processes

To put help away while you work, choose **Dismiss walkthrough** on the guide. Your form and unsaved draft stay open, and practice history is retained. Move to another task, then use **Start walkthrough** or the sidebar's **Start / resume walkthrough** to get help for that current workflow, not the dismissed task. Help does not reopen automatically. Use **Pause guide** or Escape instead when you intend to resume the same selected task.

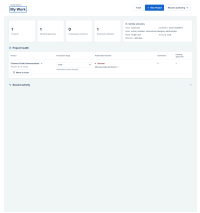
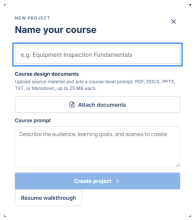
1. Manage projects and workspace
2. Import and author scenes
3. Manage templates
4. Manage imported media and accessibility
5. Author assessments
6. Import references and request enhancement
7. Review enhancement proposals
8. Generate and approve media
9. Play and comment on the storyboard
10. Validate course readiness
11. Export course deliverables
12. Back up and restore
13. Review project health
14. Work with Pythia

For the PowerPoint-to-SCORM path, start with Work with Pythia. It links the existing import, media, assessment, validation, and export tasks into one human-reviewed workflow.

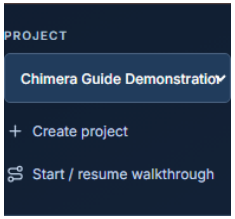

CHIMERA
PROJECT
Chimera Guide Demonstration
Create project
Start / resume walkthrough
WORKSPACE
My Work
Storyboard
Assessments
Media library
Templates
Review tools
Settings
Local workspace
COURSE AUTHORING / STORYBOARD
Chimera Guide Demonstration
Saved locally
Preview course
Export
01 SOURCE
02 STORYBOARD
03 ENHANCE
04 VERIFY
05 DEPLOY
1 publication blocker
1 pending suggestion
0 unresolved comments
Scenes 3
Import PowerPoint
Project background
01 Welcome and objectives
Content · Required
02 Knowledge check
Question · Required
03 Final review
Question · Required
Drag scenes to reorder
Edit scene
Pythia
Welcome and objectives
Scene 1 of 3 · Required
SCENE 01 · CONTENT
NATIVE LAYOUT · SOURCE SLIDE 1
SOURCE SLIDE PREVIEW
Welcome and objectives
Speaker notes: Author note: Introduce the demonstration.
1 images / 1 audio files
demonstration-audio.wav
0:00 / 0:01
Require attached audio to finish
Learners must play every attached track to the end.

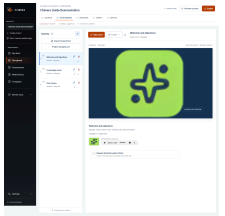
1. Manage projects and workspace

Create a project

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Click **New Project** on My Work, or **Create project** in the sidebar.	The course-name dialog opens. Cancelling keeps your current workspace.	
2	Enter a **Course name**, then click **Create project**.	A new empty project becomes active in Storyboard authoring, with production stage Draft.	

Switch projects

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open the **PROJECT** selector and choose the desired course.	The selected storyboard and project media load.	

Step	Action	Result	Control image
2	Check the course title above the workspace before continuing.	Subsequent edits apply to the intended project.	

Organize subprojects

Subprojects are full projects attached to a top-level project. Only two levels are supported; a subproject cannot have its own children. Attachment organizes work without combining content or granting access.

1. In **My Work**, open a top-level project's **Project actions**.
2. Choose **Create subproject** to name and create an empty child, or **Attach existing project** to attach a standalone project. A project that already has children cannot become a subproject.
3. Expand **visible subprojects** to see children you can access. Each retains its own production stage, blockers, and approval workflow. The parent summary counts only visible children and does not change the parent's stage.
4. Open a child's **Project actions > Manage subproject** to select a different **Parent project**, choose **None (detach to top level)**, or change **Display order**. Lower numbers appear first; ties use a stable project-ID order.
5. Use the grouped **PROJECT** or Media library selector to navigate. In child authoring, the parent breadcrumb opens the parent. Close or save current forms before switching projects.

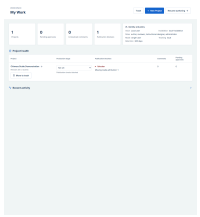
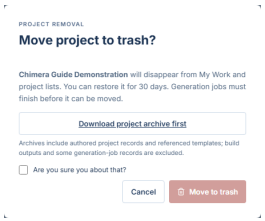
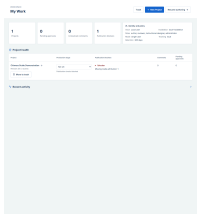
Scenes, media, background defaults, review records, permissions, completion rules, and exports remain independent. A child's scenes inherit only that child's project background, not the parent's background. Viewing a parent does not grant access to its children. Managing relationships requires settings access on the child and the affected parents; creating a subproject also requires permission to create projects. Unavailable parents are labeled without exposing their titles.

Exports and project archives include only the selected project's content, not its parent or children. Archive restore preserves the current live attachment rather than applying an old relationship from the archive.

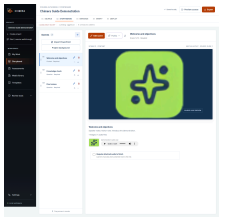
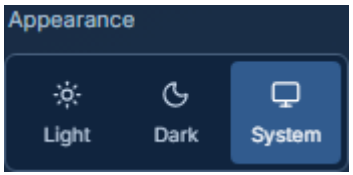
Move a project to Trash and restore it

Project owners can move a project to Trash from its row in **My Work**. Projects remain recoverable for 30 days; opening Trash removes expired entries. Projects with queued or running generation jobs must wait until those jobs finish. In shared installations, administrators can also manage project trash.

A parent with active subprojects cannot be trashed: first move, detach, or individually trash its children. Trashing a child affects only that child. In Trash, a child's **Restore parent** defaults to its original parent, provided that parent remains available and authorized. If it is unavailable, explicitly select another permitted top-level parent or **None (restore to top level)** before restoring. No content is silently reassigned.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	In **My Work**, choose **Move to trash** for the project. Optionally download its project archive first.	The confirmation explains the 30-day recovery period and archive exclusions.	
2	Select **Are you sure you about that?**, then confirm **Move to trash**.	The project disappears from active lists and authoring. If it was open, Chimera switches to another active project or an empty workspace.	
3	Open **Trash** in My Work and choose **Restore** before the recovery date.	The project and its files return to the active workspace.	

Change appearance

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open **Settings** at the bottom of the sidebar.	Appearance options become available.	
2	Choose **Light**, **Dark**, or **System**.	The preference is applied and remembered in this browser.	

Configure media connections

These connections serve media providers, not storyboard enhancement or Pythia's learning-intelligence providers. Check **Settings > Pythia** for analysis, transformation, assessment, course review, and enhancement status; see Pythia prerequisites. The dialog has six tabs: **OpenAI**, **ElevenLabs**, **Google Cloud**, **Cartesia**, **Synthesia**, and **Shotstack**. The current screenshots below show unconfigured forms with inert status fixtures, not real provider credentials.

Select a tab to view that provider's connections and capabilities. Arrow keys move between tabs; Home/End select the first/last tab. Switching away from unsaved changes asks for confirmation; confirming discards those edits and clears the entered key. Provider tabs organise settings, not the generation destination: choose the narration connection explicitly in Media library.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open **Settings > AI connection**, then the **OpenAI** tab.	OpenAI image/legacy narration settings appear; shared-installation non-admins see a read-only view.	
2	Choose approved image/audio models, enter the API key, and set request limits. Click **Save media settings**.	The key is stored in the server's OS credential store and cleared from the form. Saving fails closed when secure storage is unavailable.	
3	Click **Test provider** after saving.	A models-list request checks the credential without sending course content or generating media. Model access and costs still depend on the provider account.	
4	To disable the OpenAI connection, click **Disconnect** and confirm.	Its saved key is deleted and environment fallback is disabled, without disconnecting other narration providers. Running requests may finish; queued jobs against changed settings require resubmission.	

For **ElevenLabs**, add a named narration connection using a write-only key in the server's secure credential store or the fixed server-side `ELEVENLABS_API_KEY` environment variable. For **Google Cloud**, use server Application Default Credentials (ADC) and an optional quota project; enable the Cloud Text-to-Speech API and billing first. Google credentials/private keys cannot be pasted or uploaded through the dialog. An administrator provisions service credentials; never place secrets in Vite environment variables or course assets.

For **Cartesia**, use a write-only key in the server's secure credential store or server `CARTESIA_API_KEY`. The default model is `sonic-3.6`; the adapter uses Cartesia API version `2026-08-14`. The selected language/locale is sent with the transcript.

Speech-provider tab	Setup and discovery	Current form
ElevenLabs	Name the connection, choose secure store or server environment, save credentials, then test for voices/models.	
Google Cloud	Name the connection, use server ADC and optional quota project, save, then test for voices. No Google private-key field is offered.	
Cartesia	Name the connection, choose secure store or server environment, retain or set a supported model, save, then test for voices. Model access is not tested.	

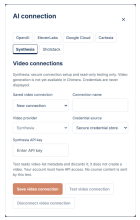
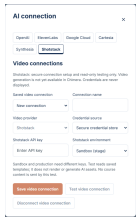
Save credentials before discovering voices; Voice can initially be blank. Test the saved narration connection, select a discovered voice (and an ElevenLabs speech model), then save again. Google uses the selected voice and language locale; ElevenLabs detects speech language through its model, with the saved language used as metadata. Tests only discover voices/models, not generate a paid audio sample or certify synthesis access. ElevenLabs and Cartesia list up to 100 voices per test; Cartesia's test does not discover models or verify model access.

In **Media library**, choose **Narration** and explicitly select a saved connection with a voice, or **Existing AI connection** for legacy OpenAI. Review its voice and language, then **Generate candidate**. Generation can incur charges; listen to the candidate before **Approve asset**, which approves and attaches it to the target scene. Disconnecting a connection removes only that connection and its owned key, not environment variables or ADC identities. Google input is limited to 5,000 UTF-8 bytes; all three separate narration adapters produce MP3.

Synthesia and **Shotstack** enable video candidates up to **30 seconds**; they never enable image/narration generation. Synthesia uses an API-enabled account key in the OS store or server `SYNTHESIA_API_KEY`; its read-only test checks video-list metadata and discards it. Shotstack has separate **Sandbox (stage)** and **Production (v1)** settings and matching keys. Use the OS store or server `SHOTSTACK_SANDBOX_API_KEY` / `SHOTSTACK_PRODUCTION_API_KEY`; switching environments in secure-store mode requires the matching new key. Its read-only test lists saved templates without submitting a render. Save, Test and Disconnect are independent for each named connection.

In **Media library** → **Create a media candidate**, choose **Video clip**, a saved connection, purpose and duration (4–30 seconds, default 30). For Synthesia, supply a title, presenter script and authorized avatar ID. The script starts from scene narration/notes; aim for about 60 words or fewer for 30 seconds. Actual duration is script-driven; renders above the chosen maximum are rejected locally but may still be billed. For Shotstack, enter the exact title text for a silent clip with fades, not a generative footage prompt. Sandbox output is watermarked.

Generate candidate can incur provider charges. Preview the returned MP4, approve it, then accept the placement proposal or attach it normally. Add/review transcripts and timed captions before publishing. Cancellation/timeouts are local: the remote render and billing may continue. Failed/interrupted jobs retain a provider operation ID; check that provider's dashboard before explicitly retrying. There is no automatic paid retry or alternate-provider fallback. See video connection details.

Video-provider tab	Connection actions	Setup screenshot (before video generation was added)
Synthesia	Name the connection, choose secure store or server environment, **Save video connection**, then **Test video connection**. A successful read-only check does not prove generation entitlement.	
Shotstack	Name the connection, select sandbox or production, supply its matching key/source, save, then test. **Disconnect video connection** removes only that named connection.	

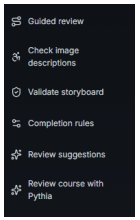
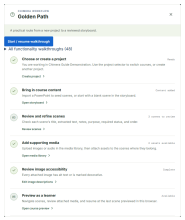
If Save is disabled, verify the connection name, credential source and required key, and whether any settings changed. If Test is disabled, save first and resolve unavailable server credentials. A voice is not required for initial discovery, but is required for narration generation. When secure storage is unavailable, use operator-provisioned server environment credentials or Google ADC rather than a plaintext fallback. Close and reopen the dialog after another administrator changes the

collection; inspect before reapplying edits. Disconnecting does not unset operator-owned environment variables or delete ADC identities.

Request limits are not spending limits. Non-OpenAI discovery, narration and video connection tests use a shared installation request counter with a fixed ceiling of 20 requests/day and one concurrent request; the OpenAI form does not configure these ceilings. Set a provider-account budget and confirm organisational data-use approval before enabling generation. See AI connection for credential-store provisioning, ADC setup and operational requirements.

Follow the guided workflow

For an interactive first-scene walkthrough, choose **Start / resume walkthrough** in the sidebar or in Guided review. The guide highlights the relevant control and advances after a confirmed project/scene save. Existing projects begin at scene creation. **Escape** or **Pause guide** hides the guide without discarding the open form; use **Resume walkthrough** inside that form to continue. Skipping a step ends the walkthrough without marking it complete. Restarting creates new practice content; it does not reset the project. See the implementation and verification record.

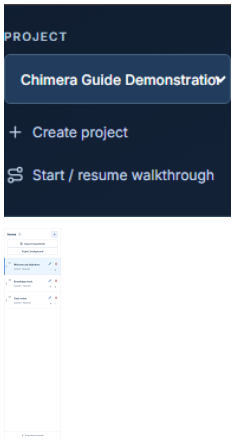
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Expand **Review tools** and click **Guided review**.	The Golden Path checklist opens.	
2	Read a step and use its action, such as **Review scenes**, **Open media library**, or **Run validation**.	Chimera opens that task; unavailable steps depend on project content.	

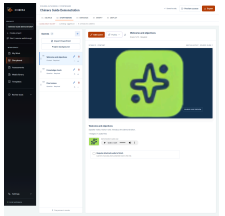
2. Import and author scenes

Scene creation and edits are saved locally. History snapshots are maintained by the application; there is no general history browser or restore-history button documented in this interface.

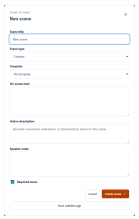
Import a PowerPoint storyboard

Importing another deck updates the project from that deck. Download a Chimera storyboard first if the current authored work must be retained independently. Captured animation XML does not guarantee equivalent playback.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Select the project, then click **Import PowerPoint** above the scene list.	The file picker opens.	
2	Choose a `.pptx` file and wait for processing.	Scenes, extracted content, and supported media appear; slide rendering may report a LibreOffice warning.	

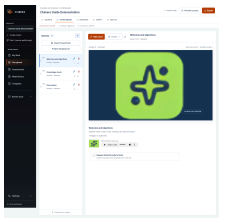
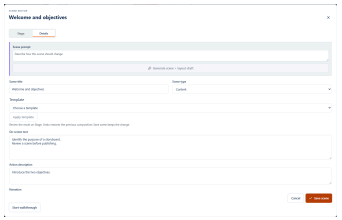
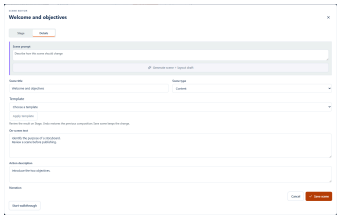
Step	Action	Result	Control image
3	Select each imported scene and inspect its text, notes, media, and preview.	You can identify extraction or rendering issues before publishing.	

Create a scene

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Click the **+** control labeled **Add scene**.	The New scene dialog opens.	
2	Enter **Scene title**, select **Scene type** and optionally choose a **Template**, and enter **On-screen text**. Set directions, notes, and **Required scene** as needed.	The new scene is prepared in the form.	
3	Click **Create scene**.	The scene is appended and saved.	

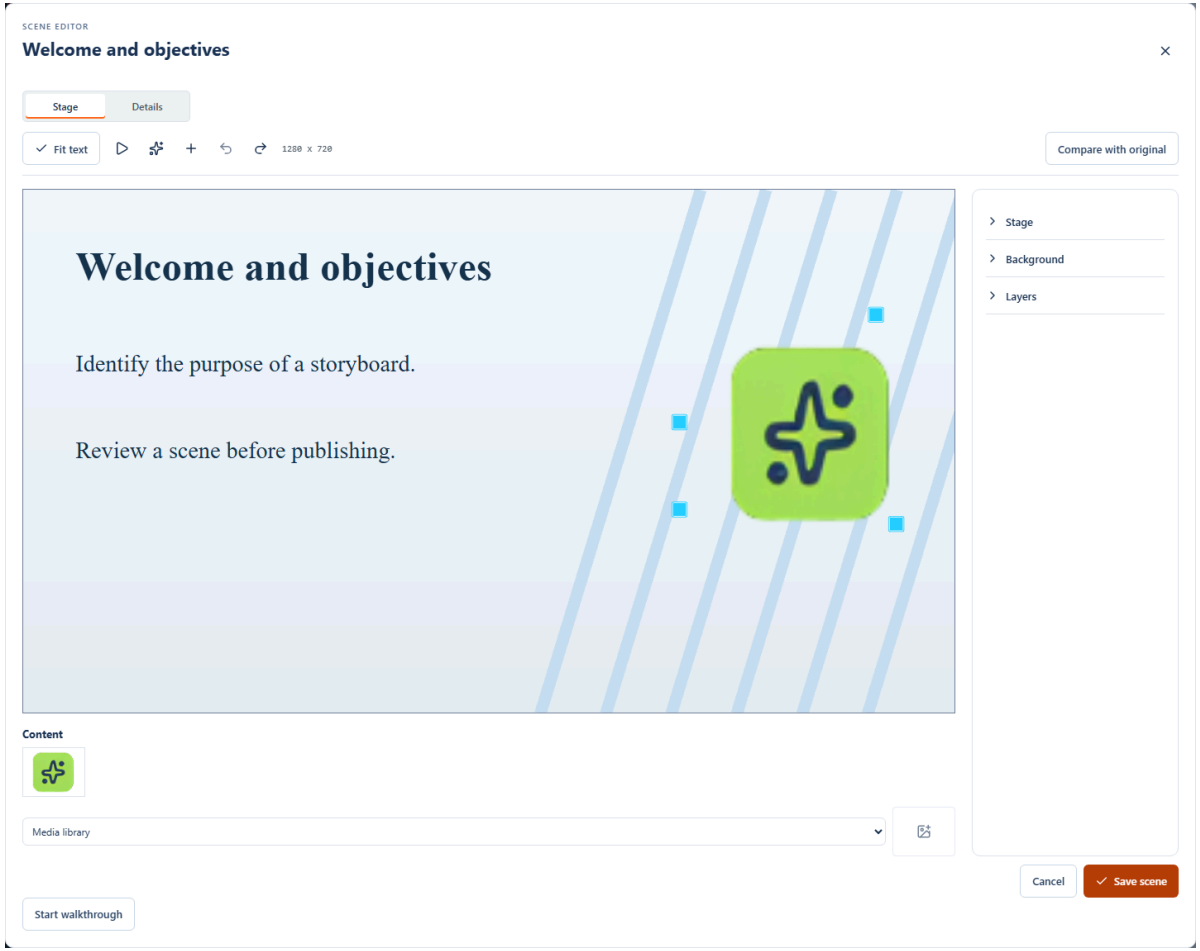
Edit scene content and settings

The **Edit scene** dialog combines scene details and canvas authoring. On-screen text is learner content; action descriptions and speaker notes are authoring material. Inspect playback and exports rather than assuming changes to extracted text redraw an imported slide image.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Select a scene, then click **Edit scene** or its pencil icon.	The unified scene editor opens on Stage; choose Details for content and settings.	 
2	In **Details**, update the title, type, on-screen text, action description, narration, speaker notes, or required status. Use **Apply template** to preview a selected design, or choose **Stage** for precise visual editing.	Both sections share one draft and one save action.	
3	Click **Save scene**; use **Cancel** to discard edits from either section.	Saved changes update the storyboard and its revision.	

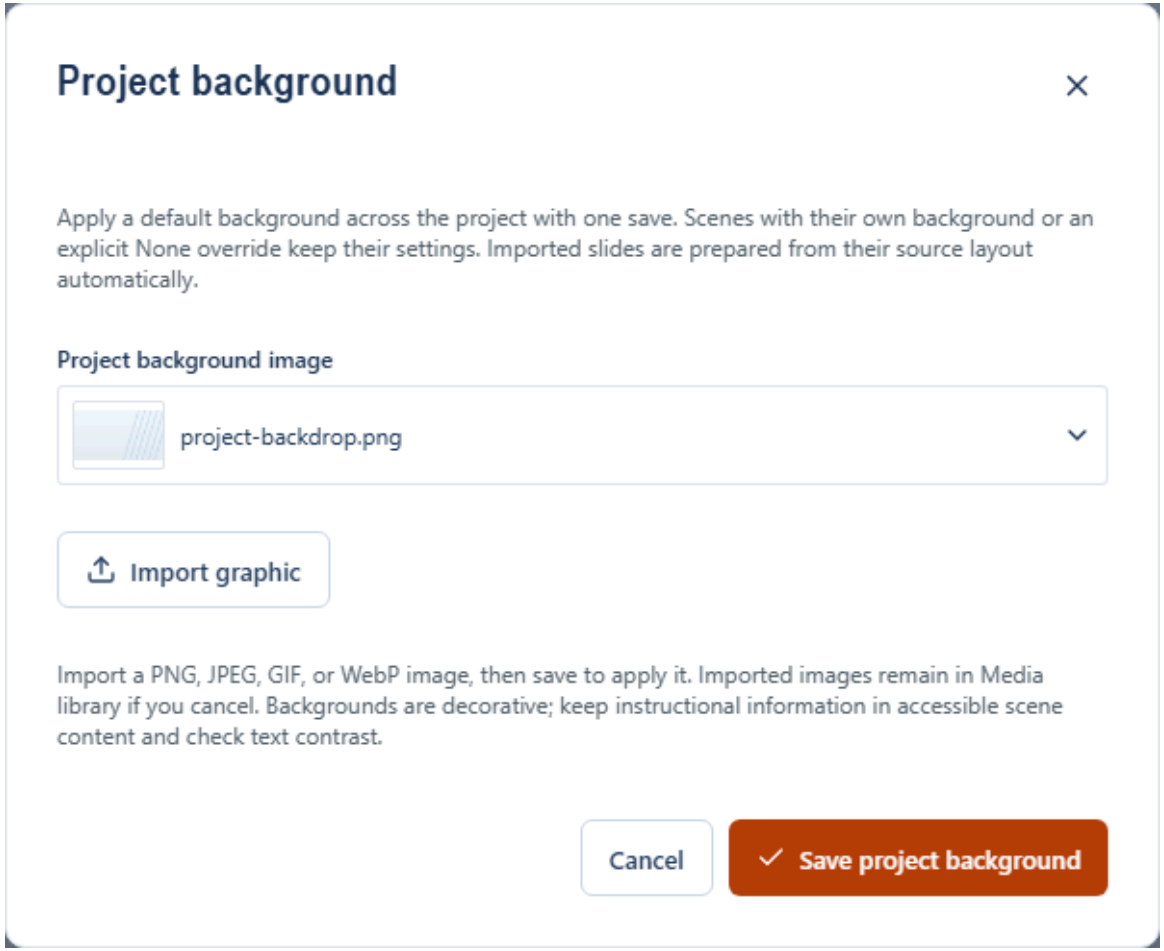
Edit text and images on the canvas

Open **Edit scene**, then choose **Stage**. The authored composition is shared by the editor, storyboard, course preview, and delivery outputs. The original PowerPoint is retained for comparison; there is no Rendering mode decision.



1. Older projects prepare missing scene compositions automatically when an editor opens them. This preserves scene IDs, text, notes, questions, review threads, existing assets, and original source files. A missing retained source produces an error rather than a generic replacement slide. Review the listed import limitations before publishing.

2. Double-click a text box, or focus it and press Enter, to edit its text directly. The **Text** field also edits the selected box. Drag boxes to move them, use resize handles, or enter exact position and size in the properties panel. Text resize handles preserve the box's current aspect ratio; image resize handles allow freeform sizing. Arrow keys move the focused element; Shift changes the step from one to ten slide-space units.
3. Drag a **Content** thumbnail onto the canvas. Clicking the thumbnail adds it without dragging. The media-library selector can add other project images. Selecting an image exposes replacement and crop-reset controls.
4. Use **Layers** to select overlapping or inherited content. Master and layout artwork starts locked; unlock it before editing. Toolbar controls add text, undo/redo, duplicate/delete elements, and change stacking order. Text properties include size, color, typeface, alignment, bold, and italic.
5. Expand **Background** in the properties panel to choose a color and open the **Background image** thumbnail picker. Choose **Use project default**, a scene image, or **None** to explicitly opt out of the project image. Imported PowerPoint master backgrounds are labeled in the picker. Set the default using **Storyboard > Project background**, above the scene list; changing it affects only inheriting scenes, not scene-specific images or explicit None choices. Use **Import graphic** in Project background, or choose an existing Media library image. Backgrounds fill the stage and are decorative; check contrast and keep instructional information in accessible text. **Compare with original**, when available, temporarily shows the original flattened slide. **Return to scene** restores the authored composition. Comparison does not change previews or outputs.
6. Choose **Save scene**, then check **Preview course**. The saved composition is shared by storyboard, course preview, Word visuals, standalone, and both SCORM profiles. **Cancel** discards unsaved canvas changes.



New imports capture editable text, images, common PowerPoint shapes, line connectors, custom freeform geometry, rotation, cropping, slide dimensions, inherited graphics, and solid/picture backgrounds. Byte-identical images are shared as one Media library asset while every source placement stays separate on the canvas. Most extracted shapes can be moved, resized, rotated, layered, locked, or deleted like other canvas elements; text inside a shape remains separately editable. The original preview remains available for comparison. Less-common preset geometry, gradients, group rotation, mixed text formatting, bullets, and some inherited styles may be approximated and are listed under **Import limitations**; charts and SmartArt remain unsupported objects. This is not full PowerPoint-equivalent editing.

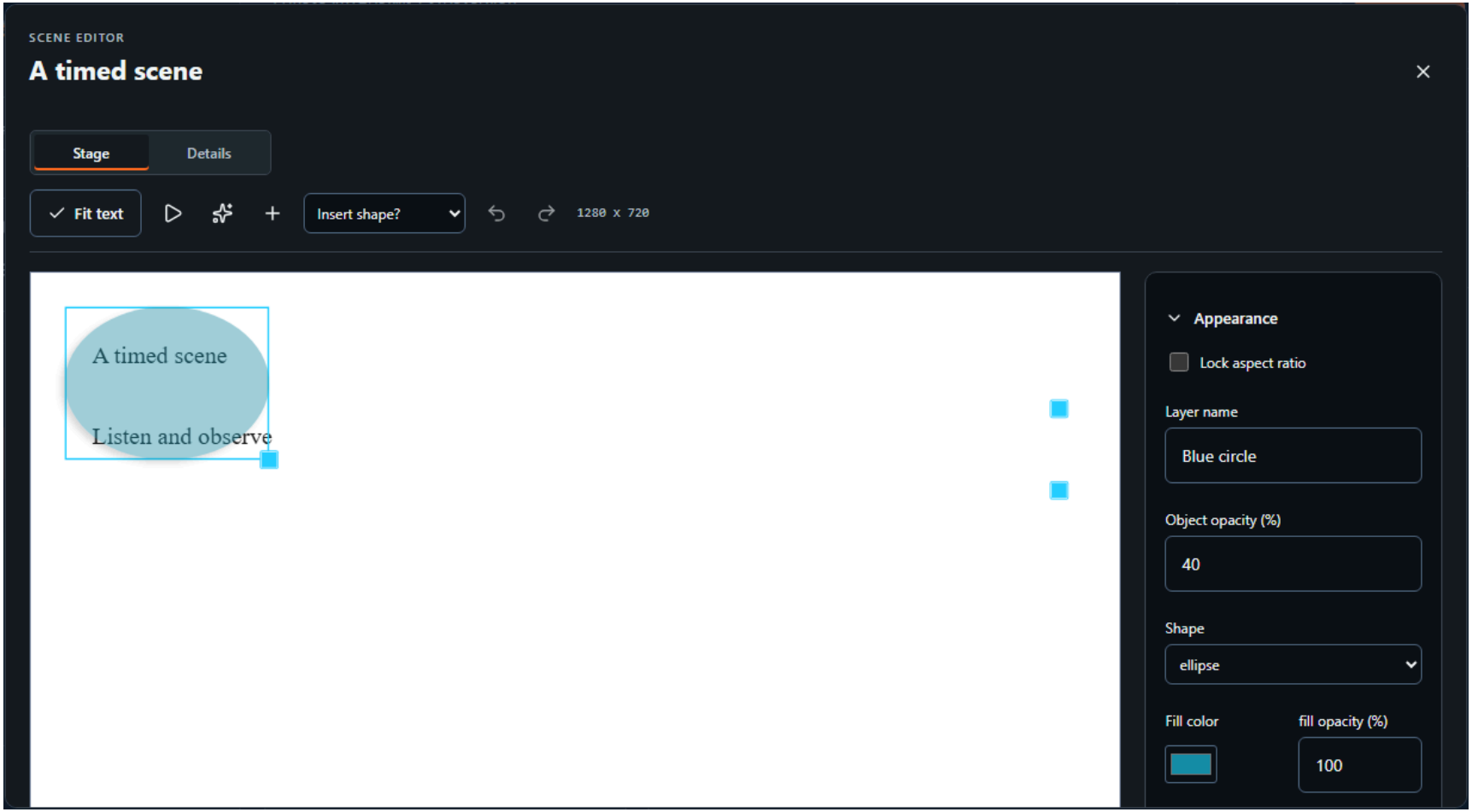
Saving content changes in Details updates the authored scene; use Stage for precise placement and text-box styling. Preview and export use the saved composition, not unsaved dialog edits.

Insert shapes and style layers

On **Edit scene > Stage**, use **Insert shape** for rectangles, rounded rectangles, ellipses, lines, arrows, triangles, and diamonds. Select the object and expand **Appearance**. Give it a layer name, set whole-object opacity, and choose fill/outline colors, their individual opacity, and outline width. Rounded rectangles also have a corner-radius control. Zero fill opacity gives an unfilled shape. **Lock aspect ratio** controls resizing; **Layout** retains exact position, size, rotation, and alignment controls.

Text also has whole-object and text-color opacity. Expand **Drop shadow**, **Bevel**, or **Emboss**, enable the effect, and adjust color, opacity, size, blur, and light angle. Each effect has its own reset. Bevel/emboss use browser silhouette-lighting approximations; they do not reproduce all PowerPoint surface treatments. Existing imported SVG shapes retain their original fills and geometry; native shape fill/outline controls apply to newly inserted native shapes.

In **Layers**, select overlapping objects, drag rows to change stacking, or use Bring forward/Send backward. Check related layers, enter a group name, and choose **Group checked layers**; moving one grouped object moves its unlocked partners. **Ungroup** removes the relationship. Three or more checked layers can be distributed horizontally or vertically. Lock, duplicate, and delete retain their existing behavior. **Hide in delivery** is a saved publishing choice; select the hidden layer in Layers to show it again. Undo/Redo applies to these draft edits.

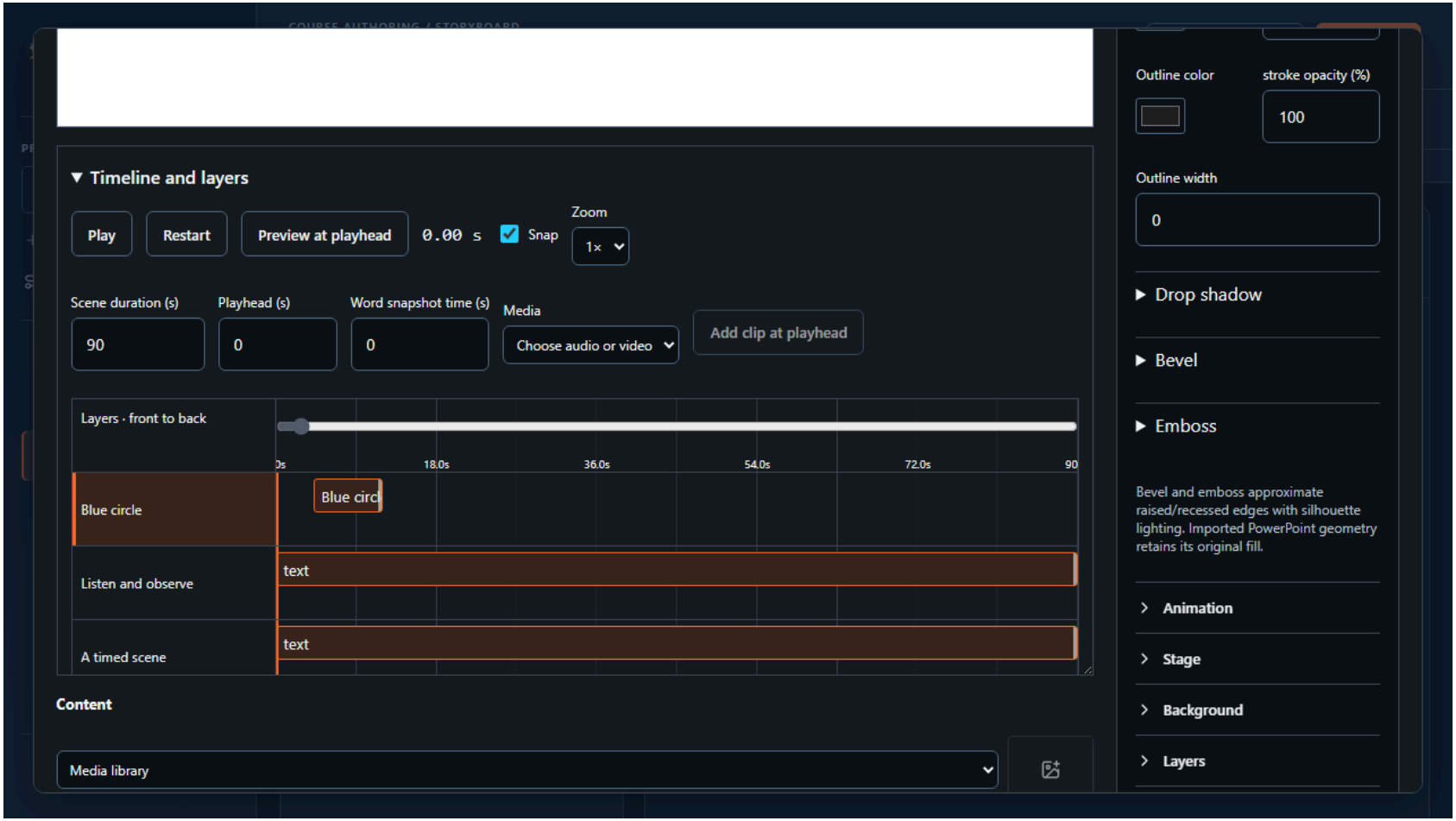


Schedule scene objects, audio, and video

Below the stage, expand **Timeline and layers** and choose **Enable scene timeline**. Existing scenes stay unchanged until you enable it; enabling the clock does not automatically schedule every attachment. Scenes support up to one hour. Scene playback starts through an explicit Play action and does not automatically advance to the next scene.

Task	Procedure
Set scene length	Enter **Scene duration (s)**. Objects, clips, animations, cue markers, and the Word snapshot time must fit. Adding or extending content can extend the duration.
Place an object in time	Select its named timeline row. Set **Object start/end (s)**, or drag its block; drag the right edge to adjust its end. The stage and row share selection.
Time native animations	Choose the entrance/presentation/exit effects in Animation. Use their blocks or timeline fields to set scene start and duration in seconds. The presentation start is displayed on the scene clock; Chimera handles its relative delay internally.
Add audio or video	Choose a project asset in **Timeline media**, position the playhead, then choose **Add clip at playhead**. Select the clip row to edit it. The same asset can appear in multiple clips.
Trim media	Set **Source in/out (s)** to select the source interval, and **Clip start (s)** to place it in the scene. Trimming preserves the original bytes. A clip starting at scene second 12 with source-in 3 starts at source second 3.
Arrange video	New clips automatically fit the scene canvas without cropping or stretching. Select an existing clip and choose **Fit video to scene** to fit the current stage size; extra space around mismatched proportions is expected. Fit supports Undo/Redo; **Save scene** retains it. Manual X/Y/width/height and layer order remain available. Existing clips stay unchanged unless you select Fit; use it again after resizing the stage. Visual objects occupy odd-numbered layer positions starting at 1; video order 0 is behind all of them and 4001 is in front.
Adjust sound	Set volume and fade-in/out durations. **Mute preview** and **Solo preview** are temporary audition controls; saved clip volume controls learner playback.
Inspect a waveform	Choose **Generate local waveform**. Sources are limited to 25 MB; decoding stays in this browser. PCM WAV has a fallback decoder; other formats require browser Web Audio support.

Task	Procedure
Add a cue	Choose **Add cue at playhead**. Cue buttons seek to their time; the adjacent × deletes a marker. Snapping uses 0.1-second steps and nearby cues.
Check timing	Use Play/Pause, Restart, the playhead slider/field, and zoom. **Return to editing** restores stage manipulation. The panel can collapse and resize vertically.
Choose a Word visual	Set **Word snapshot time (s)**. The document contains a still at that time and written clip/cue timing information, rather than a moving sequence.

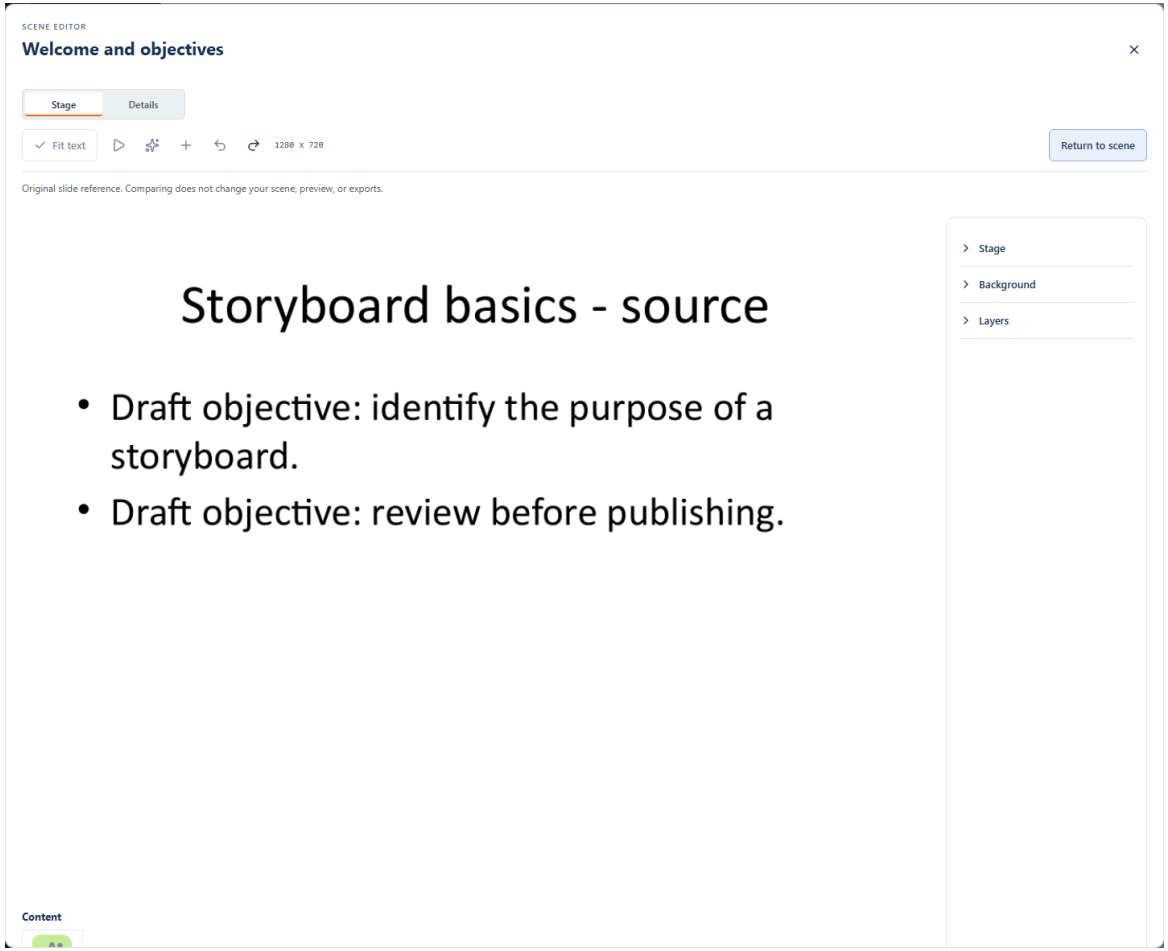


Scheduling an already attached asset replaces its independent player in that scene's learner view. Unscheduled attachments retain their existing controls. **Require viewing/listening** sets required clip coverage; existing required-audio/video rules also apply when their asset is scheduled. Seeking does not count as consumption. Every required clip has independent coverage over its trimmed interval; changing its source interval invalidates that clip's previous coverage. Avoid overlapping required narration that learners cannot follow simultaneously.

Learner preview and SCORM retain the shared scene position and earned media coverage. Standalone progress still lasts only while the page is open. Buffering or browser playback restrictions can pause the clock and show a retry message. Captions follow source time, transcripts remain available, and reduced motion suppresses movement while keeping timed visibility. Always verify the exported course and its completion rules before publishing.

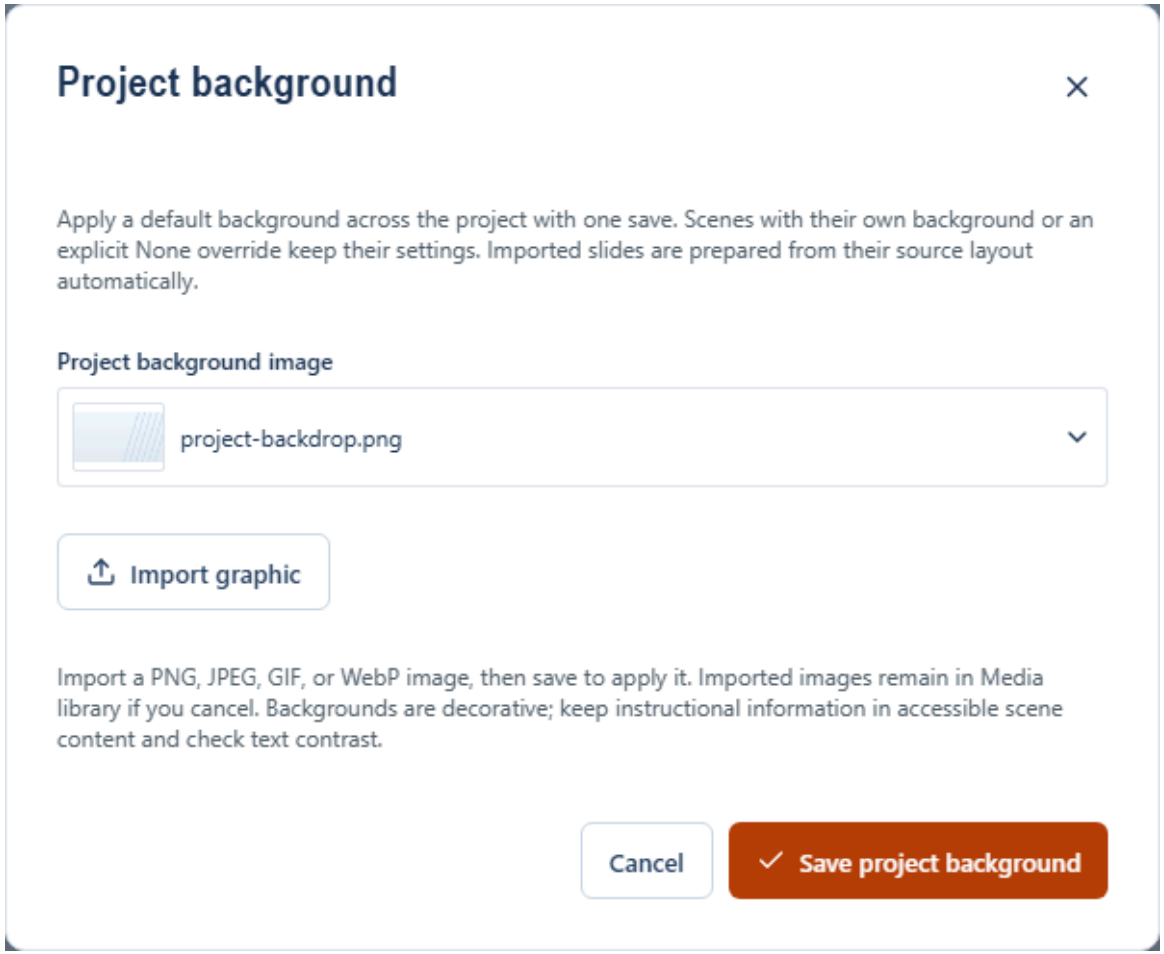
Compare with the original slide

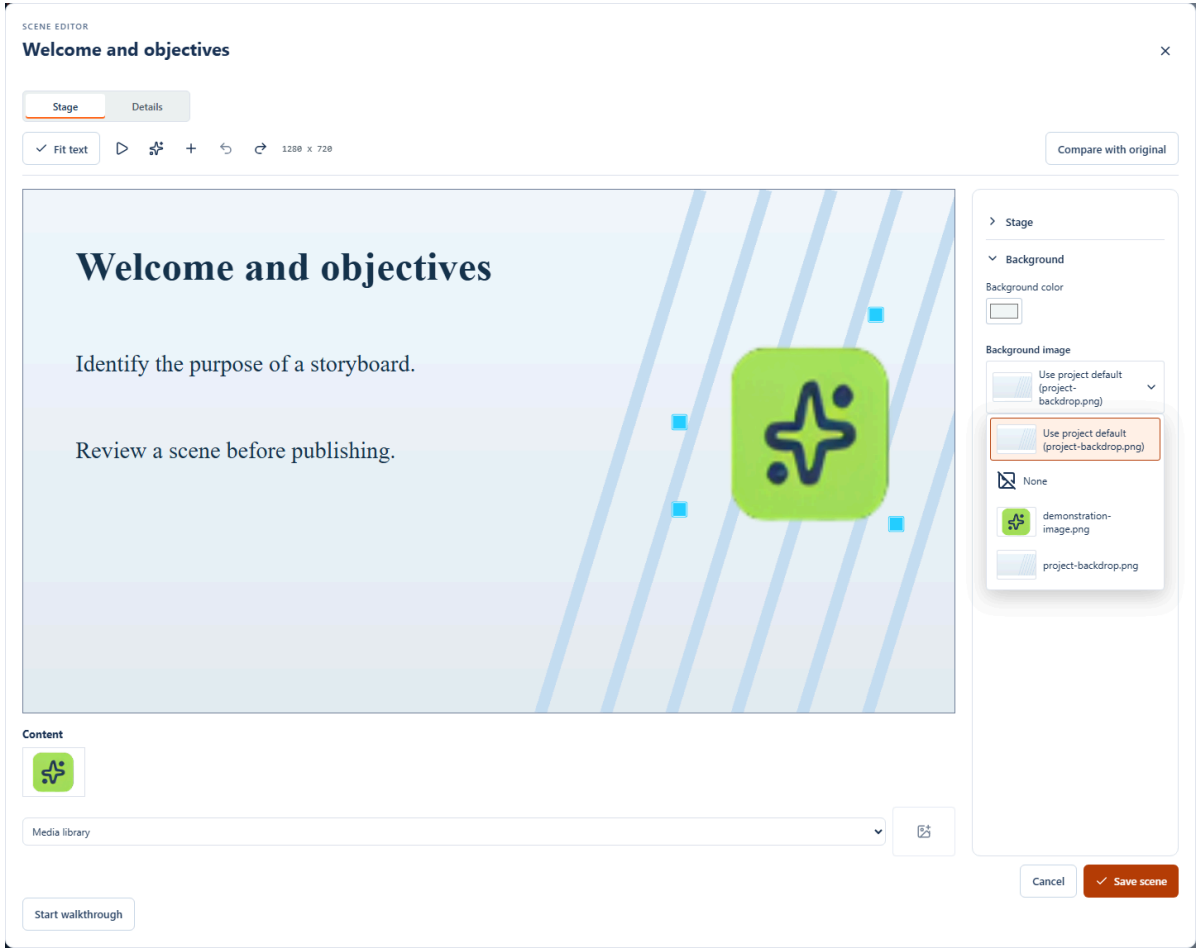
1. On Stage, choose **Compare with original** when the scene has a retained PowerPoint rendering.
2. Inspect the **Original slide reference**. Editing controls are disabled while you compare.
3. Choose **Return to scene** to resume editing. Closing and reopening the editor also returns to the authored scene. Comparison never changes storyboard preview, course preview, or exported output.



Import and apply a project background

1. Open **Storyboard > Project background** above the scene list.
2. Choose **Import graphic** and select a PNG, JPEG, GIF, or WebP image. The upload selects the image and adds it to Media library.
3. Choose **Save project background** once. All inheriting scenes update automatically, including imported slides; scene-specific images and explicit None choices remain exceptions. Cancel does not apply the background, but the imported image remains available in Media library.
4. To remove a scene exception, open **Edit scene > Stage > Background**, choose **Use project default**, and save that scene. Subsequent project changes flow through automatically. Without a project background, an inheriting imported scene can retain its original source-background baseline.





Jump directly to another scene

In **Preview course**, open **Contents** and choose a scene by number and title. The list marks the current and visited scenes. Jumping preserves assessment answers and audio-completion state, and only the selected scene becomes visited. Exported SCORM players provide a **Contents** selector with the same scene sequence.

The reviewer form follows Light and Dark appearance for labels, fields, thread text, and controls. Its contrast is qualified in both modes.

Reorder scenes

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Locate the scene in the scene list. Drag its row to the target position, or use its up/down arrow buttons.	The sequence is changed and saved.	
2	Select the moved scene and verify its position.	The course sequence reflects the intended order.	

Delete a scene

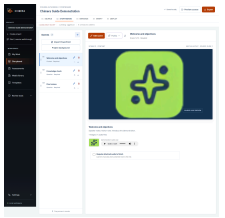
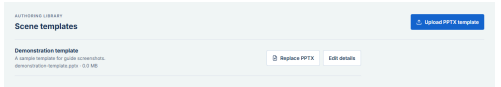
Download a Chimera storyboard before deletion when you need an accessible recovery copy. History storage does not imply a visible one-click undo control.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Select the trash icon beside the scene to remove.	A confirmation describes the deletion and relevant consequences.	

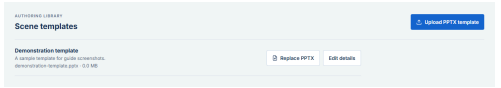
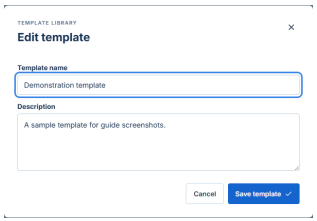
Step	Action	Result	Control image
2	Read the confirmation and confirm only if the correct scene is named; otherwise cancel.	The scene is removed after confirmation; the previous storyboard is retained in history.	

3. Manage templates

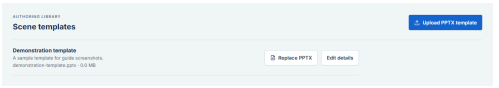
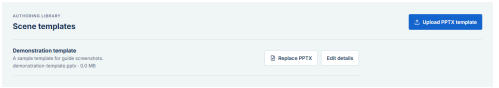
Upload a scene template

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Choose **Templates** in the sidebar.	The template library opens.	
2	Click **Upload PPTX template** and select a `.pptx` file, up to 50 MB.	The uploaded template appears in the library.	

Edit template details

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	In **Templates**, click **Edit details** for the intended template.	The template editor opens.	
2	Change **Template name** and **Description**, then click **Save template**.	The library metadata is updated.	

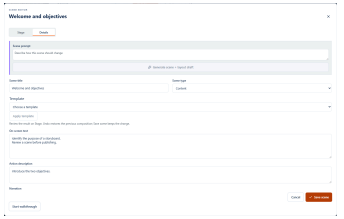
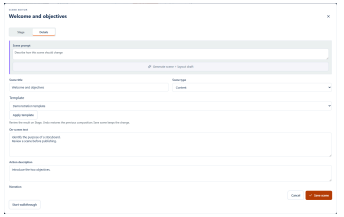
Replace a template source deck

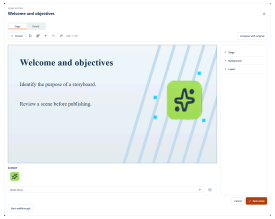
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	In **Templates**, locate the correct template and click **Replace PPTX**.	The file picker opens for that template.	
2	Choose the revised `.pptx` file and wait for completion.	The template source is replaced; inspect affected scenes before publishing.	

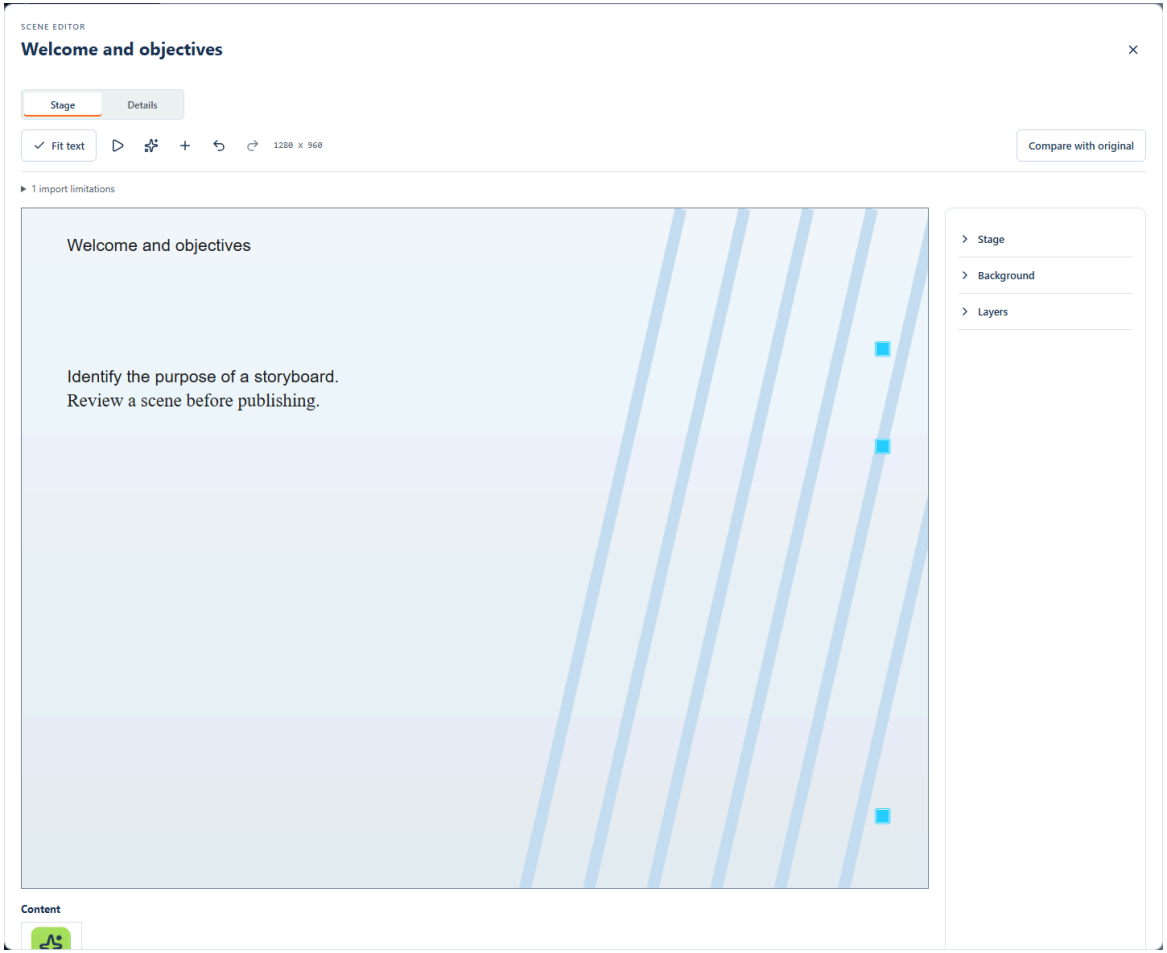
Assign a template to a scene

A template supplies the first-slide design and master/layout artwork, replacing its sample text with the scene content. It shapes the authored composition; it is not a separate rendering mode. Project defaults and explicit scene background exceptions still apply.

PowerPoint effects that Chimera cannot represent may be approximated or omitted. Use **Compare with original** and review import limitations before publishing.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open **Edit scene > Details** and choose a **Template**.	The template is selected without changing the saved scene.	
2	Choose **Apply template**.	Stage opens with the draft composition. Undo/Redo restores or reapplies the design.	

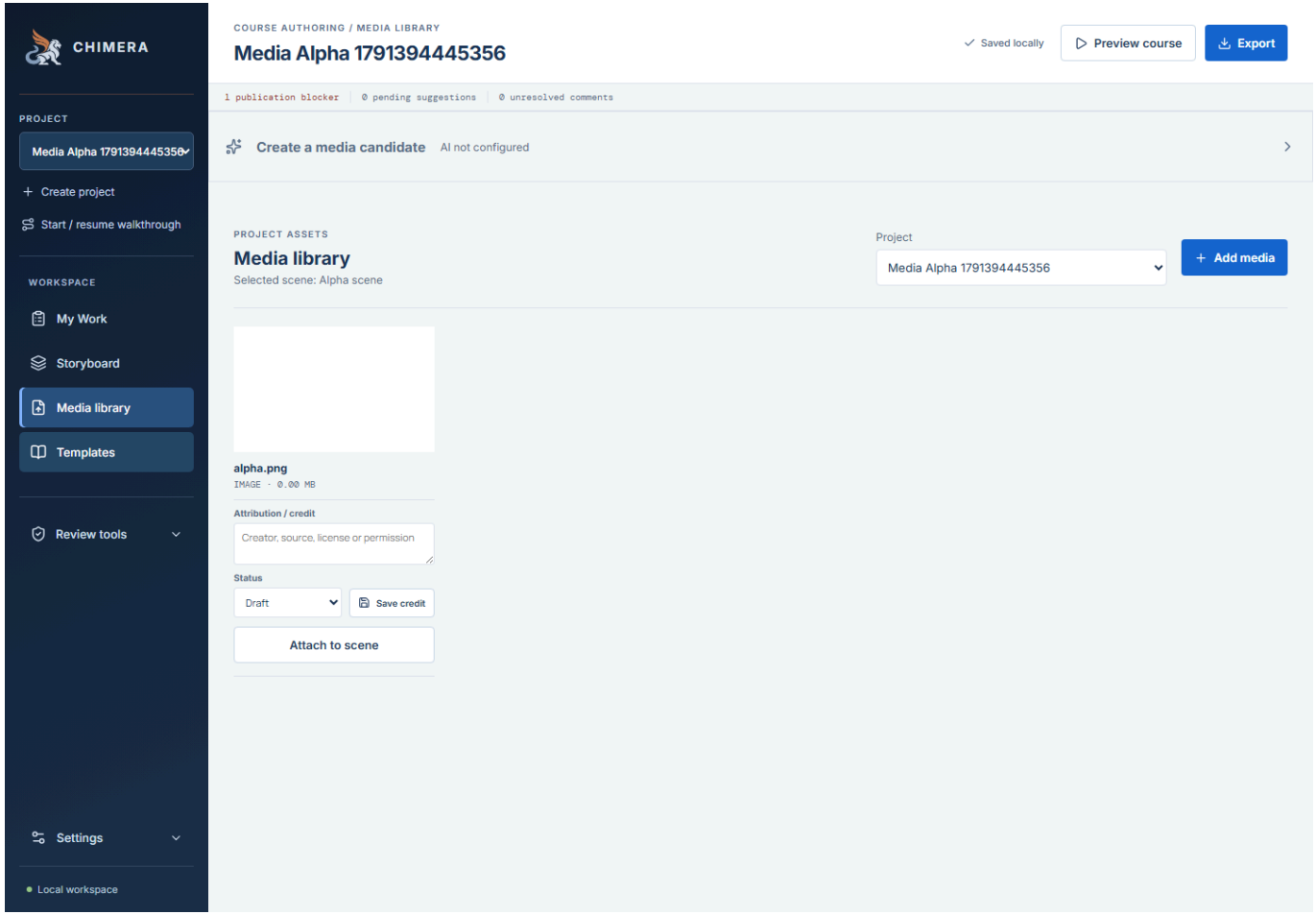
Step	Action	Result	Control image
3	Review Stage and choose **Save scene**, or cancel.	Saving keeps the composition across previews and exports. Cancel leaves the saved scene unchanged.	

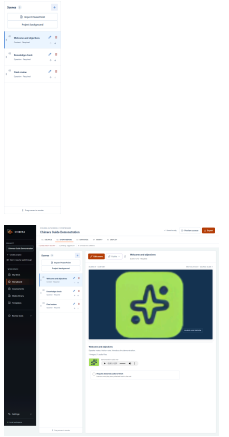
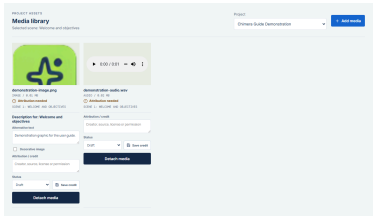


4. Manage imported media and accessibility

Media uploads support JPG/PNG/GIF/WebP images, MP3/M4A/AAC/WAV/OGG audio, and MP4/WebM video, up to 100 MB per file. Placement, course-wide media, shared-media copies, captions, and OCR are described in media placement and OCR. These authoring controls do not imply that every configured provider can generate those formats.

Add external media



Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Select the intended scene in **Storyboard**, then open **Media library**.	The media view identifies the selected scene.	
2	Select the intended project using **Project** (defaults to the current project), then click **Add media** and choose a supported file.	The asset is added to the selected project library. Adding media does not by itself attach it.	

Create a media candidate

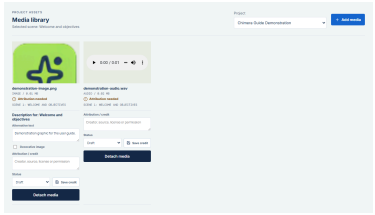
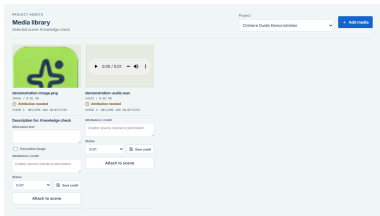
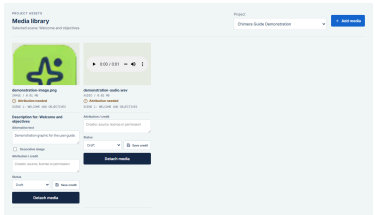
Configure image and narration generation through **Settings > AI connection** before generating candidates. OpenAI images/legacy narration and ElevenLabs/Google Cloud/Cartesia narration have separate provider tabs. Synthesia/Shotstack connection setup does not yet enable video generation. In shared deployments, an installation administrator manages these connections. See AI connection for credential storage, connection testing, limits, and data handling. These connections are separate from Pythia.

Create a media candidate starts collapsed. Select its heading to expand it. When no usable image or narration connection is configured, its heading is greyed and generation controls are disabled. A narration-only connection does not enable image generation. Narration requires explicit connection selection; the saved voice and language populate the form and can be overridden for that candidate. If connection status cannot be loaded or your role does not permit generation, controls also remain disabled. Configuration availability does not guarantee that a provider is reachable or supports a particular model. Existing candidates can still be approved or rejected without a configured connection; regeneration uses the candidate's original connection and fails if it was removed rather than choosing another provider.

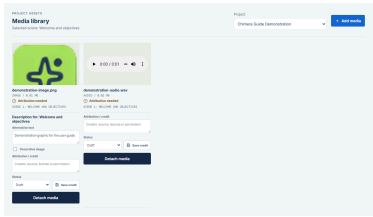
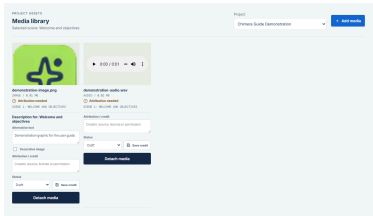
The Media Library project selector defaults to the current project. Selecting another project opens that project's media library and makes it the current project; media files are not copied between projects.

Attach or detach scene media

The screenshot shows an attached example and its Detach media button. The same control reads Attach to scene when the asset is not attached.

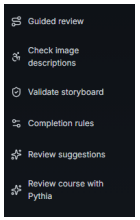
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Select the target scene in **Storyboard**, return to **Media library**, and locate the asset.	The selected scene determines the attachment target.	 
2	Click **Attach to scene**. For an attached asset, click **Detach media** to remove the scene association.	The scene reference changes; detaching does not delete the library asset.	 

Record media attribution

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	In a media card, fill **Attribution / credit** with creator, source, and license or permission information.	Attribution text is prepared.	
2	Choose **Draft** while unfinished or **Complete** when verified, then click **Save credit**.	The attribution status is saved. Production validation reports pending image attribution as a warning so export can proceed; verify the credit before release.	

Describe scene images

You can enter **Alternative text** or select **Decorative image** directly in an image's Media library card beside its attribution. The description heading identifies the selected scene. For an attached image, **Save credit** also saves the scene description. For an unattached image, **Attach to scene** saves the attachment, description and credit; saving credit alone does not attach the image or persist its pending description. Descriptions are scene-specific, so editing one scene does not overwrite another scene's description of the same image.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open **Review tools** → **Check image descriptions**.	Attached images are grouped by scene.	

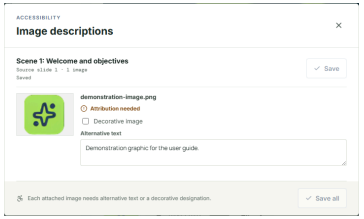
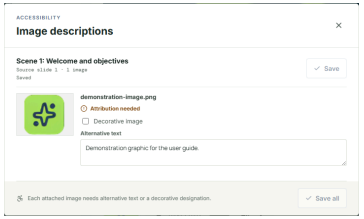
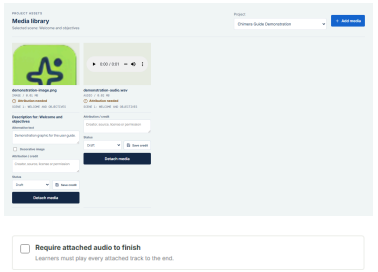
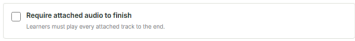
Step	Action	Result	Control image
2	Enter **Alternative text** describing the image information, or select **Decorative image** when appropriate.	Each image has a description or explicit decorative designation.	
3	Click **Save** for a scene or **Save all** for all edited scenes. Closing the panel also saves pending changes.	Saved and unsaved states are visible. A failed save leaves the panel open with your draft intact.	

Image groups identify the current storyboard scene number and title, plus the source slide when available. Media library items list every scene that uses the image or audio.

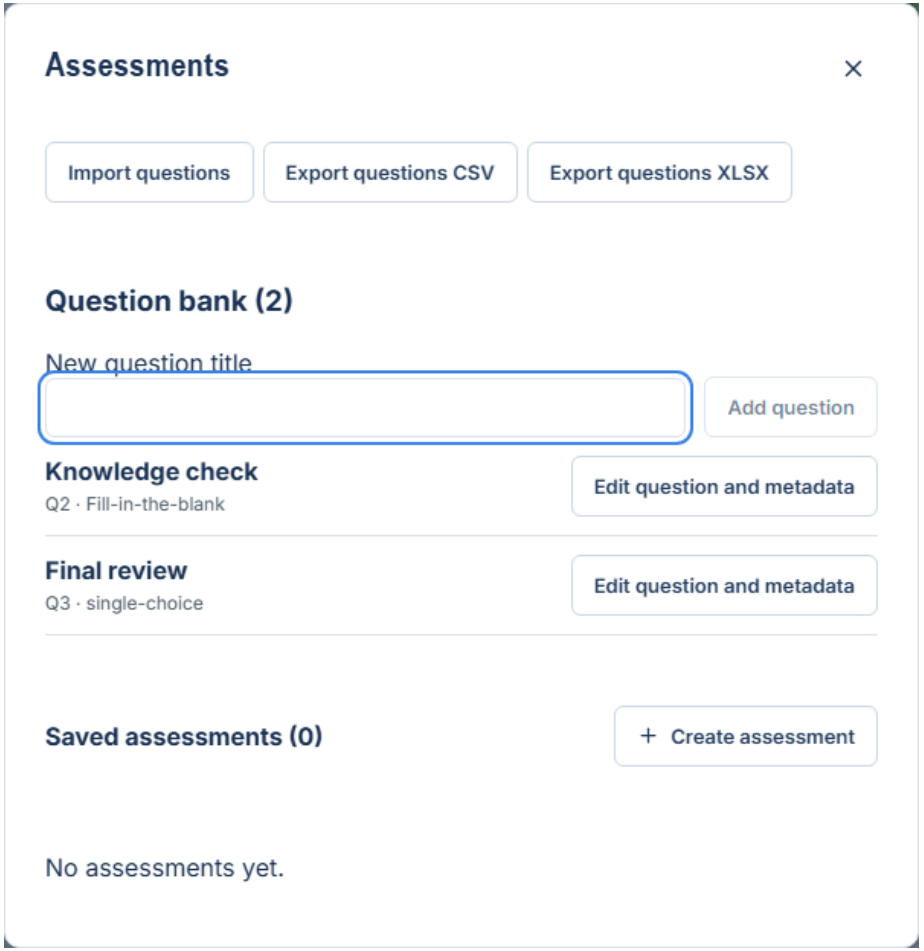
A green **Ready for production** check means the media loaded, its attribution is saved as Complete with credit text, and any image description or decorative designation is saved. In the Media library, images must meet the description requirement in every referencing scene; unattached media is not marked ready. Amber indicators identify pending saves, missing descriptions or attribution, and unavailable media. Image attribution marked **Attribution Pending** is a warning that does not block export, but the credit must be verified before release. Incomplete audio attribution remains a blocking production error. This is media readiness, not visual approval or whole-course release approval; run Production validation before release.

Require audio completion

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Attach audio to the scene, then return to its storyboard view.	The required-audio checkbox is available below the scene.	
2	Select **Require attached audio to finish**.	Learners must finish every attached track for that audio requirement.	

5. Author assessments

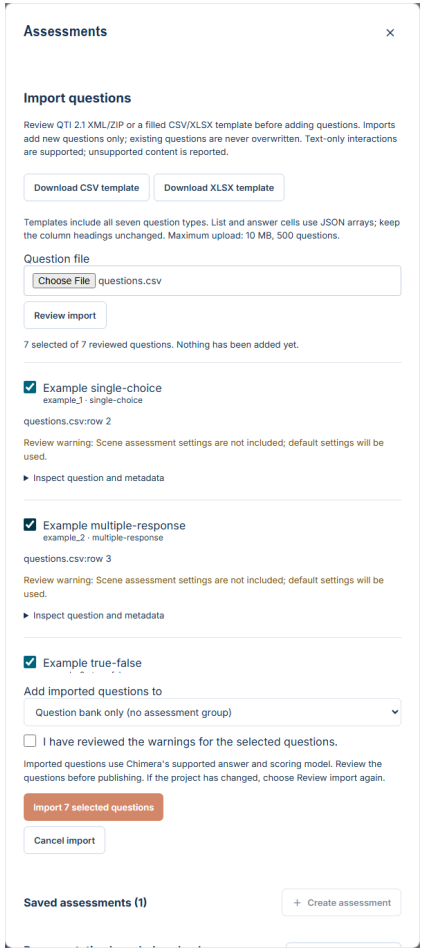
For an assessment-first workflow, open **Assessments** under **WORKSPACE** in the left rail. The **Question bank** lets you add a question directly or open an existing question and its metadata without creating a slide first. Create a named assessment, select its questions, arrange them, and download its QTI test package.



Start each assessment task with a scene whose **Scene type** is **Assessment**. Set that type in Edit scene and save. Select **Create question** for a new question or **Edit question** for an existing one. The question editor supports seven types. Changing types replaces the type-specific question structure in the form; save only after checking the new content.

Import questions with review

1. Open **WORKSPACE > Assessments > Import questions**.
2. Select a QTI 2.1 item XML, QTI ZIP package, or filled CSV/XLSX template. Download either template in the import panel; each contains examples of all seven types.
3. Choose **Review import**. Nothing is saved at this stage. Inspect the question, answer key, feedback, metadata, errors, and warnings for each row.
4. Select the valid questions to add. Existing stable identifiers and repeated identifiers in the upload are blocked, not renamed or overwritten. Correct duplicates in the source file and review it again.
5. Optionally select a saved assessment to receive the new questions. Otherwise they enter the question bank only.
6. Acknowledge any warnings, then choose **Import selected questions**. The selected questions and group membership are saved together. If another author changed the project, review the file again before importing.



Uploads are limited to 10 MB and 500 questions. QTI import supports the representable text-only subset of the seven question types, not arbitrary LMS question formats, media, rich HTML, or custom response processing. Unsupported content is reported rather than silently discarded. Test-level navigation, selection, timing, and scoring policies are not imported as a test; choose and review Chimera's assessment rules separately.

CSV/XLSX templates use one question per row and these columns:

Columns	Content
`identifier`, `type`, `title`, `prompt`	Stable question ID, one of the seven type names, authoring title, and learner prompt.
`choices`, `secondaryChoices`	JSON arrays of `{"identifier":"A","text":"Answer"}` objects. For matching and drag-and-drop, use primary items in `choices` and targets/right items in `secondaryChoices`.
`answers`	JSON array of correct choice IDs, ordered IDs, accepted answer strings, `"true"`/`"false"`, or `{"sourceIdentifier":"A","targetIdentifier":"B"}` pairs, depending on type.
`correctFeedback`, `incorrectFeedback`, `caseSensitive`	Feedback and fill-in-the-blank case-matching behavior.
`description`, `tags`, `author`, `source`, `language`, `difficulty`, `learningObjectiveRefs`	Question metadata. Tags and objective references are JSON string arrays. Difficulty is blank, `easy`, `medium`, or `hard`. Language uses a tag such as `en-US`.

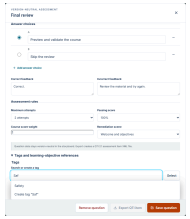
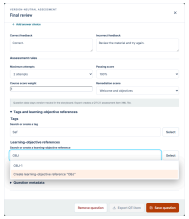
Use the supplied examples rather than changing the headers. XLSX formulas are not evaluated or imported as question content. Spreadsheet imports do not carry assessment membership or course-specific rules. **Export questions CSV/XLSX** downloads authored questions and metadata in the same format.

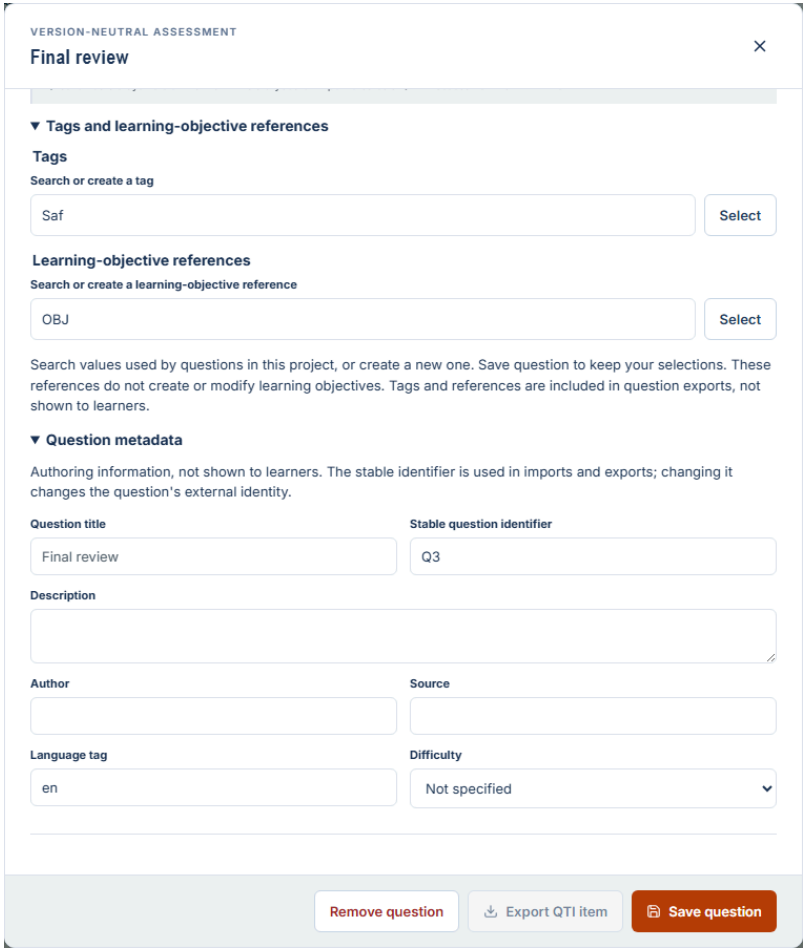
Edit question metadata



Open a question and expand **Tags and learning-objective references** at the bottom of the editor. This section starts collapsed; both fields use compact search/dropdowns. Focus the search field or choose **Select** to open its scrollable dropdown. Suggestions come from saved questions in the current project; search is case-insensitive and excludes values already selected. Select a suggestion to reuse its spelling, or choose **Create** (or press Enter) for a new value. Arrow keys navigate dropdown options; Enter selects and Escape closes the dropdown. Use **Remove** to remove a selected value, then **Save question** to persist your selections. Each field

allows up to 50 values, each up to 200 characters. Expand **Question metadata** for its title, stable identifier, description, author, source, language, and difficulty. Tags and other metadata are authoring information and are not shown as learner-facing question content. References are identifiers or labels; adding them does not create or modify learning objectives.

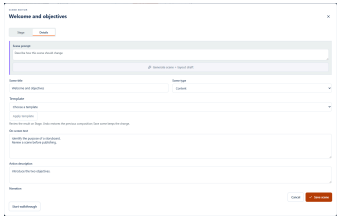
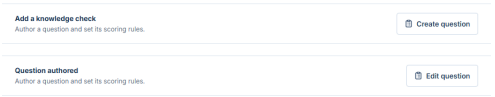
Search existing tags or create one	Search existing learning-objective references or create one
	



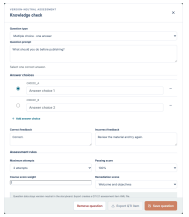
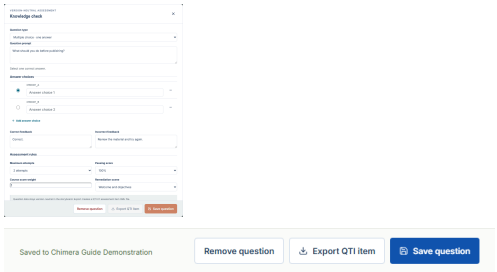
The stable identifier starts with a letter and contains up to 64 letters, digits, underscores, or hyphens. Keep it unchanged when maintaining a question's identity outside Chimera. Title defaults to the scene title when not specified. Tags and objective references accept up to 50 unique entries, at most 200 characters each.

Metadata is retained in project data and spreadsheet exports. QTI uses the standard item title and XML language attributes; remaining Chimera metadata and supported item settings travel in a `chimera` XML processing instruction for round trips. Other QTI systems may ignore this extension. Course-specific remediation links cannot be carried into another project and are reported during import. QTI import/export still requires qualification against the target LMS; export availability is not a certification of LMS compatibility.

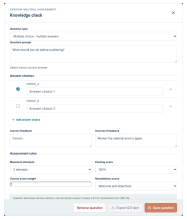
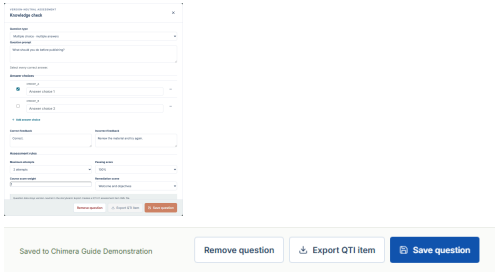
Open or create an assessment question

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Edit the scene, choose **Assessment** under **Scene type**, and save.	The scene displays the question-authoring section.	
2	Click **Create question** or **Edit question** below the canvas.	The question editor opens.	

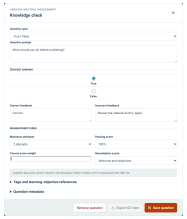
Author a single-choice question

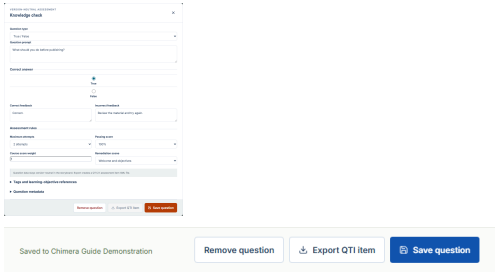
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Choose **Multiple choice · one answer**, enter the **Question prompt** and answer text, and mark exactly one answer as correct. Use **Add answer choice** or the minus buttons as needed.	The question content and correct response are defined.	
2	Enter **Correct feedback** and **Incorrect feedback**, then click **Save question**.	The question is saved to the scene.	

Author a multiple-correct question

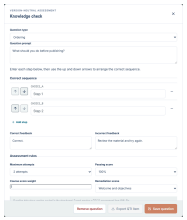
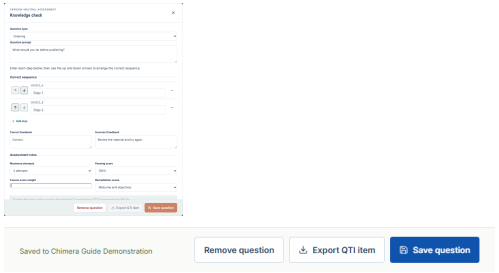
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Choose **Multiple choice · multiple answers**, enter the prompt and answer choices, and select the checkbox for every correct answer.	The question content and correct response are defined.	
2	Enter **Correct feedback** and **Incorrect feedback**, then click **Save question**.	The question is saved to the scene.	

Author a true/false question

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Choose **True / False**, enter the statement as the prompt, and select **True** or **False** under Correct answer.	The question content and correct response are defined.	

Step	Action	Result	Control image
2	Enter **Correct feedback** and **Incorrect feedback**, then click **Save question**.	The question is saved to the scene.	

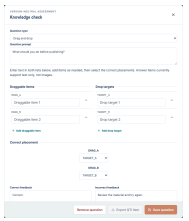
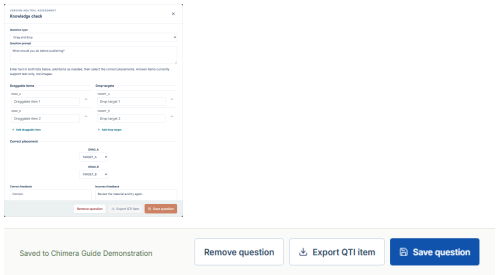
Author an ordering question

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Choose **Ordering**, enter the prompt and steps, and use the earlier/later arrows to establish the **Correct sequence**. Use **Add step** as needed.	The question content and correct response are defined.	
2	Enter **Correct feedback** and **Incorrect feedback**, then click **Save question**.	The question is saved to the scene.	

Author a drag-and-drop question

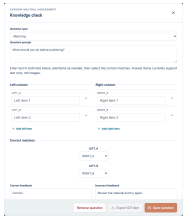
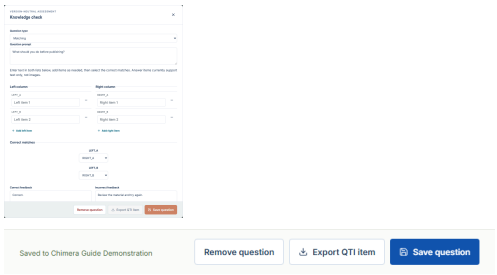
Type each draggable item and drop target into its text field. Use **Add draggable item** or **Add drop target** to extend either list, then assign the correct placements below the lists. Answer items currently support text only; images on the scene Stage are not draggable answer choices.

In **Preview course** and exported SCORM courses, the targets form a vertical list below the answer tiles. Drag a tile to its matching label, or select a tile and then select its target using a mouse, touch, or keyboard. Correct tiles settle beside the label and leave the answer bank; incorrect tiles return home. Drops do not use attempts; only **Check answer** does. The question Stage expands to contain the targets and **Check answer**; scroll the preview for longer questions.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Choose **Drag and drop**, enter the prompt, draggable items, and drop targets, then choose each correct placement. Use distinct targets for the intended matches.	The question content and correct response are defined.	
2	Enter **Correct feedback** and **Incorrect feedback**, then click **Save question**.	The question is saved to the scene.	

Author a matching question

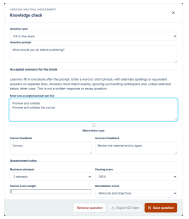
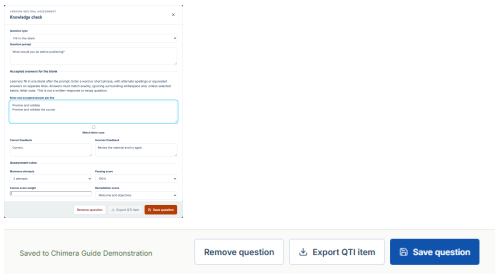
Type the items into the **Left column** and **Right column** text fields. Use **Add left item** or **Add right item** as needed, then assign the **Correct matches** below the lists. Matching answer items currently support text only, not image choices.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Choose **Matching**, enter the prompt and left/right items, then select each correct match.	The question content and correct response are defined.	
2	Enter **Correct feedback** and **Incorrect feedback**, then click **Save question**.	The question is saved to the scene.	

Author a fill-in-the-blank question

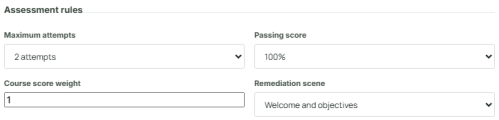
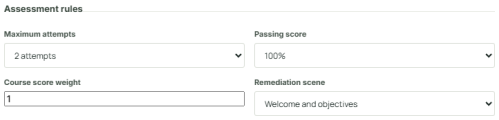
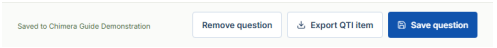
Fill-in-the-blank replaces the former Short answer name. Learners enter one word or short phrase in a single blank after the prompt; this is automatically graded, not an essay or manually marked written response. Enter alternate accepted spellings or equivalent answers on separate lines. Matching ignores surrounding whitespace and, unless **Match letter case** is selected, capitalization.

Existing questions and imported/exported CSV/XLSX templates retain the `short-answer` type identifier for compatibility; no conversion of saved answers is needed. QTI 2.1 exports use an inline `textEntryInteraction` inside a paragraph and a single primary correct-response value, with exact string comparisons retaining all accepted alternatives. This corrects the former block-level placement of the blank. Blackboard import compatibility still needs verification in the target Blackboard version; a QTI 2.1 package is not a Blackboard-native question pool.

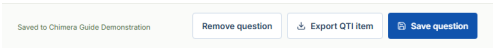
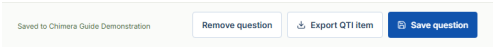
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Choose **Fill-in-the-blank**, enter the prompt, and enter one accepted answer per line. Select **Match letter case** only when capitalization must match.	One blank and its accepted answers are defined.	
2	Enter **Correct feedback** and **Incorrect feedback**, then click **Save question**.	The question is saved to the scene.	

Configure question scoring and remediation

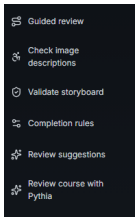
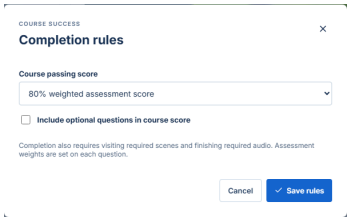
Current question scoring is binary: 0% or 100%. Course score weights affect the aggregate course score; they do not create partial credit within a question.

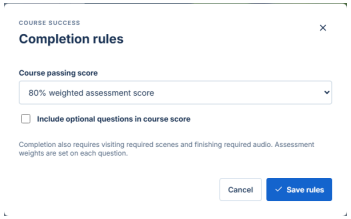
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open the question editor and scroll to **Assessment rules**.	Question-level settings are visible.	
2	Set **Maximum attempts**, **Passing score**, **Course score weight**, and an optional **Remediation scene**.	Attempts, scoring contribution, and review destination are specified.	
3	Click **Save question**.	The question and its rules are saved.	

Remove an assessment question

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open the existing question and click **Remove question**.	A removal confirmation appears.	
2	Confirm removal if intended.	The question is removed from the scene; the scene remains.	

Set course completion rules

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open **Review tools** → **Completion rules**.	Course-level scoring controls open.	
2	Select **Course passing score** and whether to **Include optional questions in course score**.	The aggregate scoring policy is prepared.	

Step	Action	Result	Control image
3	Click **Save rules**.	The policy is saved. Required scene visits and required audio also contribute to completion.	

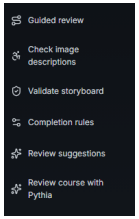
6. Import references and request enhancement

This section describes **New enhancement run**, which uses Pythia's `storyboard.enhance` capability. It is separate from the analysis, transformation, assessment, and course-review dialogs described in Work with Pythia. Only the references selected in this form accompany this enhancement request; they are not automatically included in the other Pythia workflows.

Enhancement submission requires an available Pythia Engine supporting `storyboard.enhance`, managed by an administrator in shared installations. Check **Settings > Pythia**, not **AI connection**. Without it, Preview submission remains useful, but Submit run is disabled. This documentation update made no live AI requests and does not certify provider output.

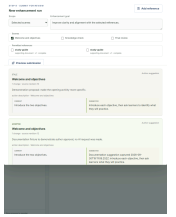
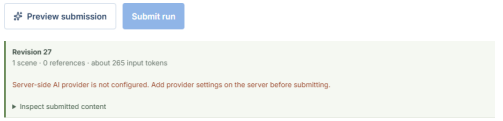
Import a Study Guide or supporting reference

Failed or incomplete extraction disables selection. The current form does not provide full resource classification, version-management, or scene-mapping editors.

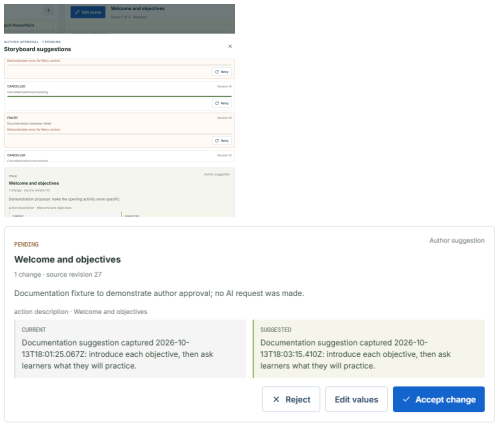
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open **Review tools** → **Review suggestions**.	Storyboard suggestions opens with the New enhancement run form.	
2	Click **Add reference** and select PDF, DOCX, PPTX, TXT, or MD, up to 25 MB.	Chimera imports the resource and attempts text extraction.	

Step	Action	Result	Control image
3	Check the extraction status under **Permitted references**. Select the resource only if extraction is complete.	Selected references become eligible for the enhancement request.	

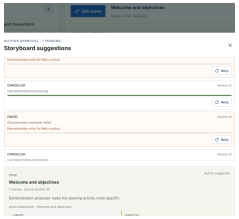
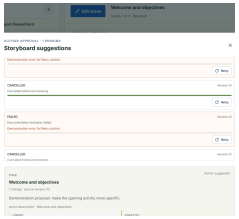
Select enhancement scope and inspect the submission

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Choose **Whole course** or **Selected scenes** under **Scope**; for selected scenes, check the required scene boxes.	The enhancement target is defined.	
2	Enter an **Enhancement goal** and check the **Permitted references** to include.	The run is limited to the chosen content and references.	
3	Click **Preview submission**, then expand **Inspect submitted content**.	You can inspect the payload, source revision, counts, estimated input units, and any available cost estimate.	

Submit an enhancement run

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Complete and inspect the submission preview. Resolve any Intelligence Engine unavailable or unsupported-capability message.	You know what will be sent and whether submission is available.	
2	Click **Submit run** when enabled.	An enhancement job is created; it produces proposals rather than directly applying changes.	
3	Review the job status and any reported resource conflicts, then review returned suggestions individually.	You can distinguish completion, failure, and suggestions needing a decision.	

Cancel or retry an enhancement job

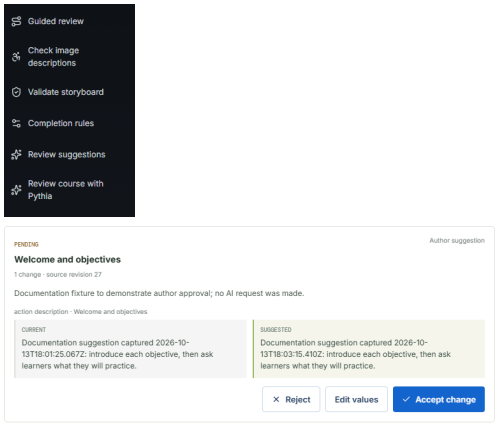
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	In Storyboard suggestions, find the run under **Enhancement jobs**.	Its status and message are visible.	
2	Click **Cancel** for a queued/running job, or **Retry** for a failed/cancelled job after addressing the cause.	Cancellation is requested or a retry job is started. Neither action approves proposals.	

7. Review enhancement proposals

Review suggestions contains several proposal types. The **Accept change**, **Edit values**, and **Undo acceptance** instructions below apply to regular enhancement proposals, including native assessment items drafted by Pythia. Pythia analysis uses **Accept review** without changing content; storyboard transformation uses **Edit proposal** and **Accept transformation**, with no undo button. Follow the Pythia-specific decision steps for those records.

Accept or reject a suggestion

A proposal can contain multiple related changes. Accept change applies that displayed proposal as a group, so review every included change. A source-backed label is not a substitute for checking the source.

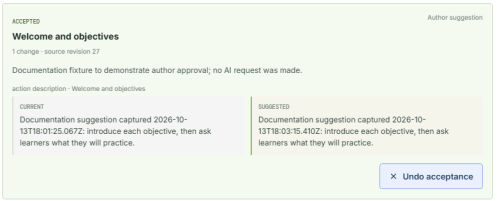
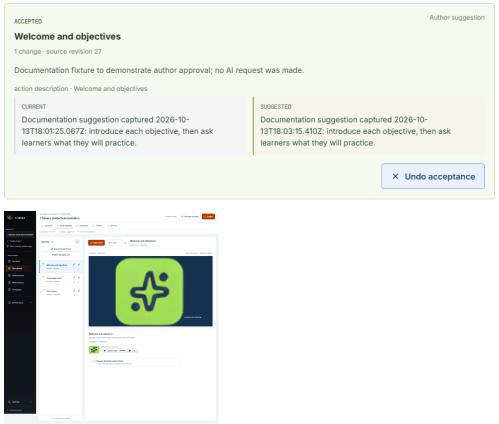
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open **Review tools** → **Review suggestions** and locate a pending proposal.	The proposal shows its rationale, source revision, and changes.	
2	Compare **Current** and **Suggested** for every included change; inspect citations if provided.	You understand the complete proposal before deciding.	

Step	Action	Result	Control image
3	Click **Accept change** to apply the proposal, or **Reject** to leave the storyboard unchanged.	The decision is recorded. A stale/conflicting proposal cannot overwrite newer edits.	

Edit a suggestion before accepting

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	On a pending proposal, click **Edit values**.	Editable suggested-value fields appear.	
2	Revise the suggested values. Structured values are labeled JSON and must remain valid JSON; use **Cancel edit** to discard these form edits.	The displayed proposed content reflects your intended version.	
3	Click **Accept change**.	The edited proposal is applied if valid and current.	

Undo an accepted suggestion

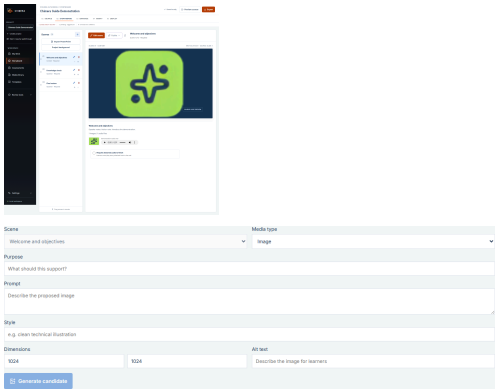
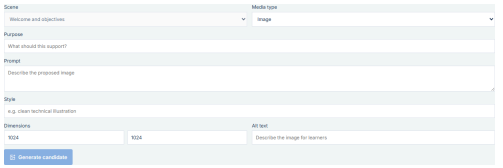
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Locate the accepted proposal and click **Undo acceptance**.	Chimera attempts to restore the captured previous values.	
2	Inspect the resulting scene or any conflict message.	Reversal succeeds only when later changes do not prevent a safe restore.	

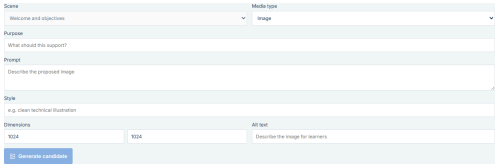
8. Generate and approve media

Select the target project and scene before opening Media library. Create a media candidate starts collapsed; expand its heading to access the form. Without AI configuration or generation permission, the section is greyed and generation/regeneration is disabled. Existing candidates remain reviewable. Approval attaches a candidate to its target scene; choose **Edit scene > Stage** afterward to place supported image assets. A generation-cost preview and full media-job monitor are not provided.

Request an image candidate

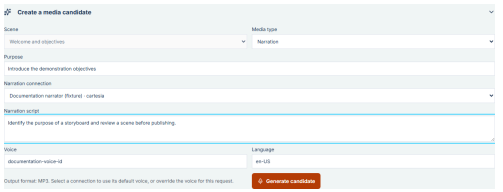
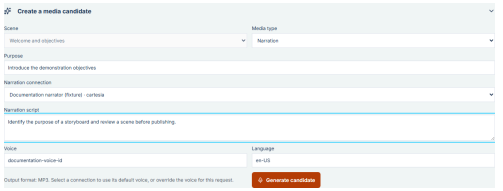
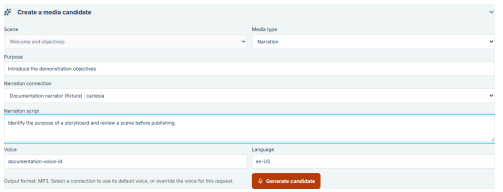
The current provider implementation sends the prompt and dimensions to image generation; put essential style directions in Prompt as well. Candidate appearance does not guarantee source or factual accuracy.

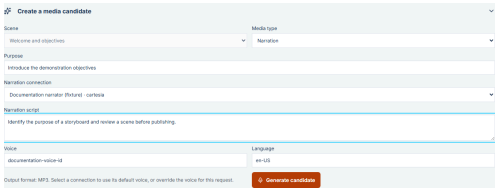
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open **Media library**, expand **Create a media candidate**, and verify Scene. Set **Media type** to **Image**.	The selected scene is the generation target.	
2	Enter **Purpose**, **Prompt**, optional **Style**, **Dimensions**, and **Alt text**.	The request form describes the candidate. Provider support determines valid dimensions.	

Step	Action	Result	Control image
3	Click **Generate candidate** and wait for a candidate or error.	A successful request yields a pending candidate without attaching it to the storyboard.	

Request narration

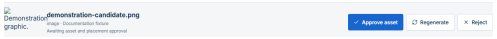
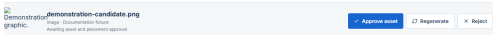
First configure a speech-provider connection as described under Configure media connections. The image below uses a named documentation-only Cartesia capability/voice fixture; no speech was generated. Synthesia and Shotstack do not appear in the narration selector.

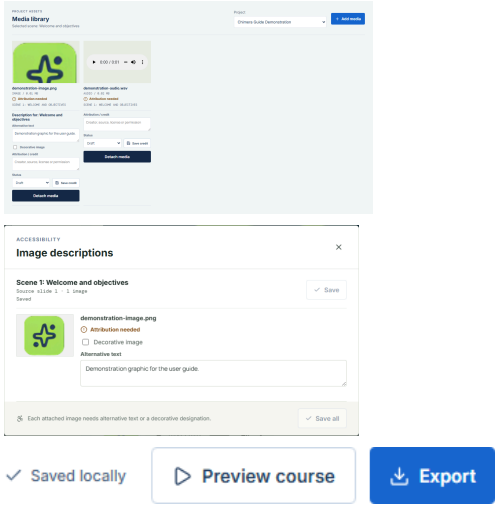
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	In Media library, expand **Create a media candidate**, set **Media type** to **Narration** and verify the target scene.	Narration fields replace image fields; narration is selected automatically when only speech is configured.	
2	Explicitly choose **Narration connection**. Use a named ElevenLabs, Google Cloud or Cartesia connection, or **Existing AI connection** for legacy OpenAI.	Saved voice/language populate the form. No provider is silently selected for you.	
3	Enter **Purpose** and **Narration script**; review or override the provider-supported **Voice** and **Language**.	The request is prepared. Google scripts must fit 5,000 UTF-8 bytes; ElevenLabs spoken language is model-detected rather than forced by this metadata field.	

Step	Action	Result	Control image
4	Click **Generate candidate**.	A successful, potentially billable provider run returns an MP3 audio candidate for review, not automatic approval. Missing/changed connections report errors rather than switching providers.	

Provider discovery sends no course text and is not an audio-quality check. Explicit generation sends the script to the selected provider and can incur charges. If no narration connections are offered, save a voice on a credential-configured speech connection and reopen the media library; a configured video-only connection is not sufficient. Regeneration retains the candidate's original connection ID, and queued jobs fail if their saved connection revision changes.

Approve, reject, or regenerate a media candidate

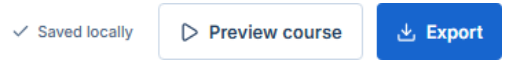
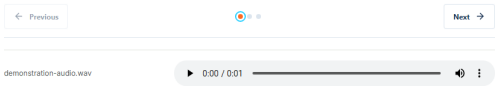
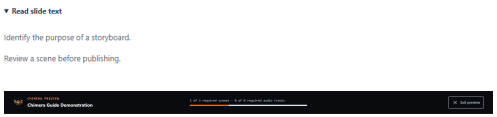
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Inspect the image or listen to the audio under **Candidate review**. Confirm that the selected scene is the intended target.	You review the asset before attachment.	
2	Click **Approve asset** to approve and attach it, **Reject** to discard the candidate from consideration, or **Regenerate** to request another candidate.	Only approval places the candidate into the active project/scene; regeneration may incur provider usage.	

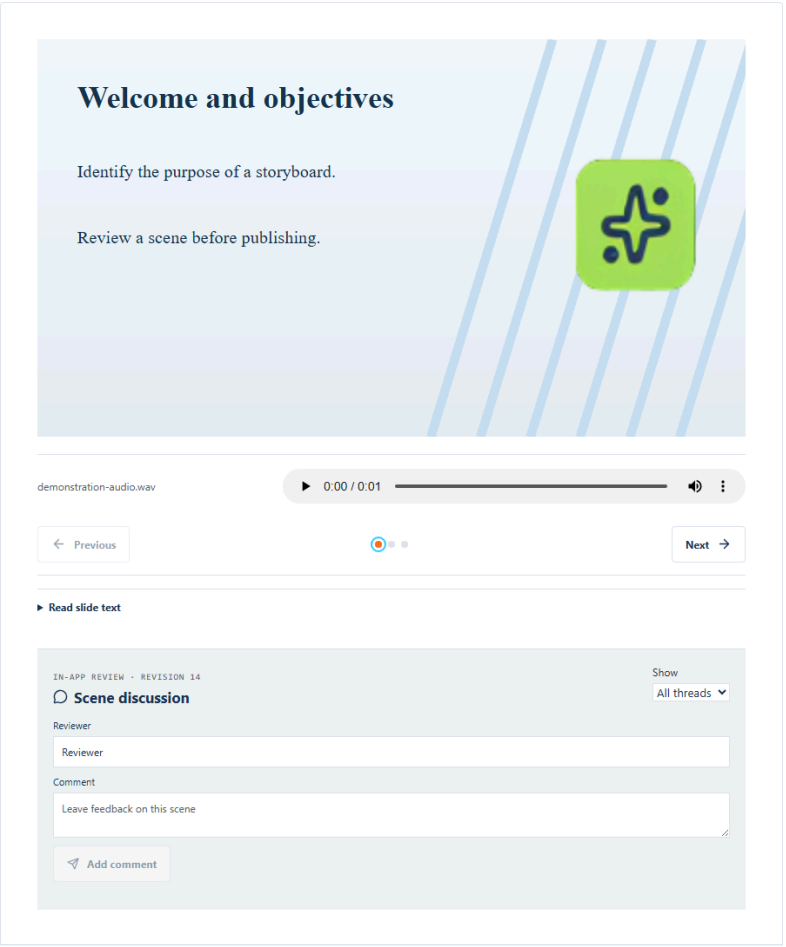
Step	Action	Result	Control image
3	After approval, check the asset in the media library, its attribution, accessibility details, and course preview.	The approved asset is reviewed in its actual context.	

9. Play and comment on the storyboard

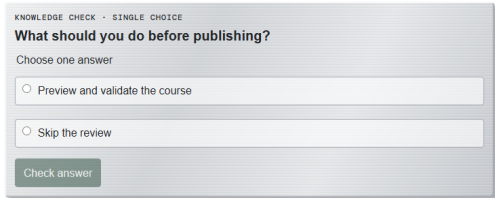
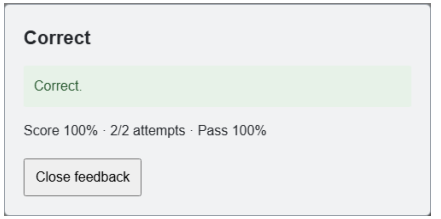
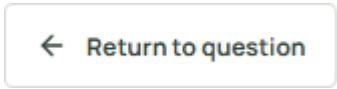
Preview shows the saved authored scene. Previous/Next and scene dots stay directly with the presentation; slide text and scene discussion follow below. Original comparison in the editor does not switch preview to the source image. Preview progress is stored in this browser, separately from a learner's LMS session. In-app discussion is available. Hosted authenticated review links are documented in the authentication deployment guide; local guest review and timestamp-entry controls are not available.

Play the storyboard

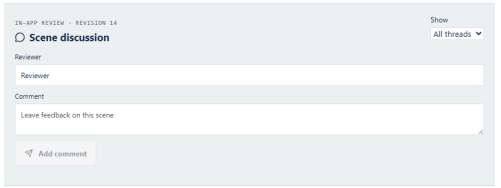
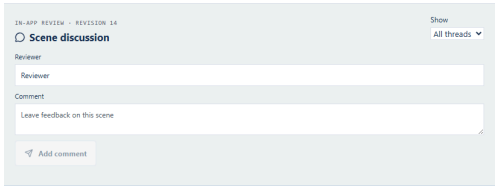
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Click **Preview course** in the top bar.	The playable storyboard opens.	
2	Use **Next**, **Previous**, or a scene navigation dot. Play attached audio with its player controls.	You review scene order, content, and media; required progress updates.	
3	Expand **Read slide text** below navigation when the scene has saved on-screen text. Click **Exit preview** to return to authoring.	You can inspect extracted text and resume editing.	


Welcome and objectives
Identify the purpose of a storyboard.
Review a scene before publishing.
demonstration-audio.wav
0:00 / 0:01
Previous
Next
Read slide text
IN-APP REVIEW · REVISION 14
Scene discussion
Show
All threads
Reviewer
Reviewer
Comment
Leave feedback on this scene
Add comment

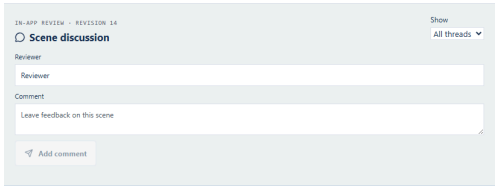
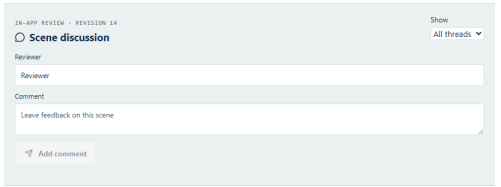
Test an assessment in preview

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Navigate to the assessment scene. Select an answer, enter text, order items, or match/drag items as appropriate.	A response is prepared.	
2	Click **Check answer**; use **Try again** when offered after an incorrect attempt.	Feedback, score, and attempt count appear. Correct answers or exhausted attempts disable further attempts.	 
3	If **Review lesson** is offered, follow it and use **Return to question** to resume.	The remediation path is exercised.	 

Add a scene comment

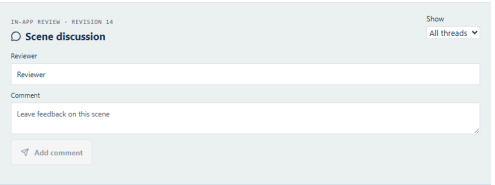
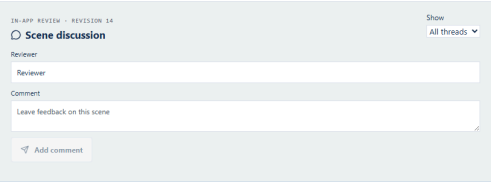
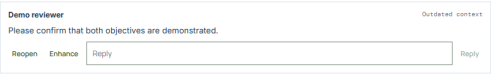
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	During preview, navigate to the scene and scroll to **Scene discussion**.	Feedback will be associated with that scene and review revision.	
2	Enter **Reviewer** and **Comment**, then click **Add comment**.	A persistent discussion thread is created.	

Reply to a comment

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Find the thread in Scene discussion and enter text in its **Reply** field.	A reply is prepared.	
2	Click **Reply** beside the field.	The reply is added to the thread.	

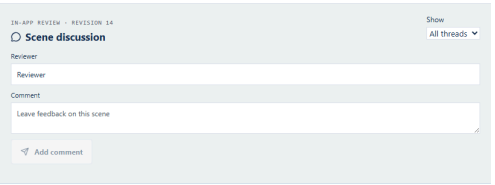
Resolve, reopen, and filter comments

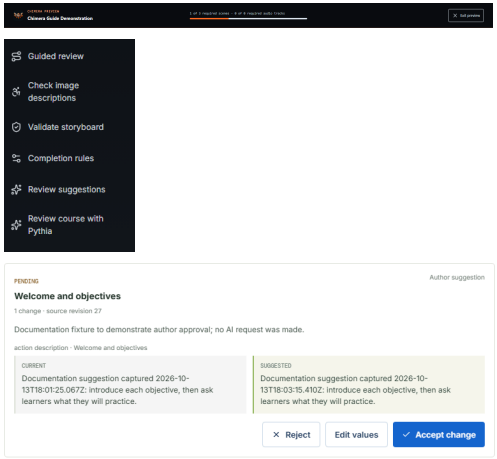
Outdated context means the underlying review context has changed; revisit the current scene before acting on that feedback.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Choose **All threads**, **Unresolved**, or **Outdated** from **Show**.	The discussion list is filtered.	
2	Click **Resolve** on an addressed thread.	The thread is marked resolved.	
3	Choose All threads if necessary, then click **Reopen** to resume discussion.	The thread becomes unresolved again.	

Request enhancement from a comment

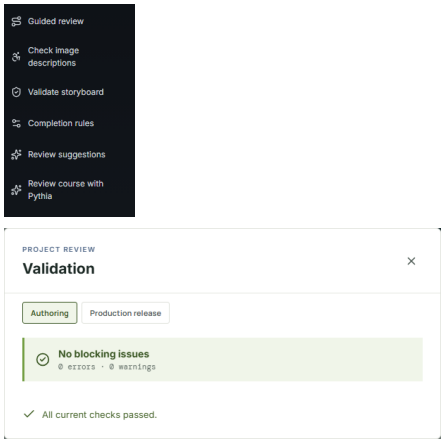
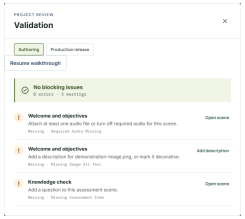
This shortcut submits no reference resources in the current implementation. Use the normal enhancement form when you need selected references or a submission preview.

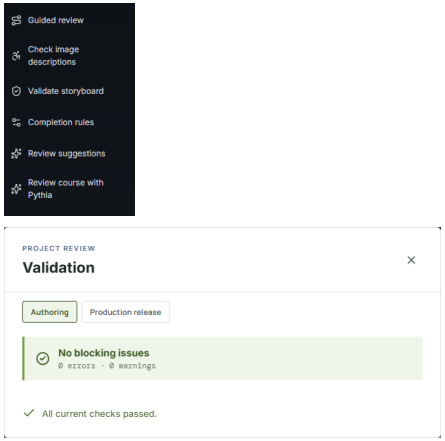
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Read the comment and click **Enhance** on its thread.	Chimera requests enhancement for that scene using the comment as the goal. This action submits directly when the provider is configured.	

Step	Action	Result	Control image
2	Exit preview and open **Review tools → Review suggestions** to inspect the job and any proposals.	Suggestions still require explicit approval.	

10. Validate course readiness

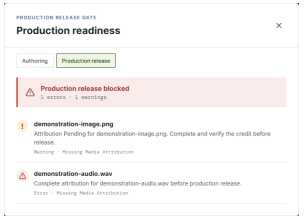
Validate an authoring draft

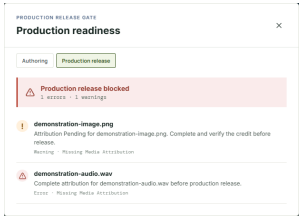
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open **Review tools** → **Validate storyboard**.	The validation report opens in Authoring mode.	
2	Review errors and warnings. Use **Open scene** or **Add description** where offered.	The relevant editor opens so you can fix the issue.	

Step	Action	Result	Control image
3	Save corrections and reopen validation.	A new report reflects the saved storyboard.	

Check production readiness

Passing validation is not certification for every LMS. Pending suggestions and unresolved discussion should be reviewed deliberately; they do not automatically represent published changes.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	In validation, click **Production release**.	Chimera runs production checks.	

Step	Action	Result	Control image
2	Resolve blocking errors, including missing assets, and inspect warnings such as **Attribution Pending** for images. Reopen the report after changes.	The report shows blocking production errors separately from pending image credits; export can proceed with that warning.	

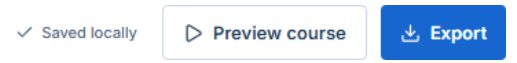
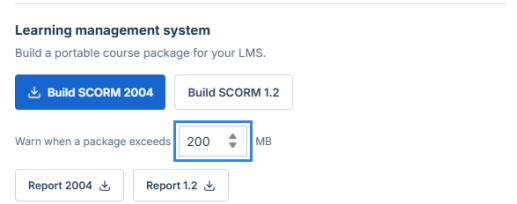
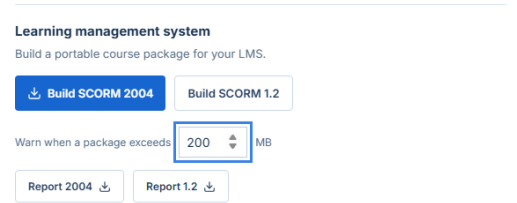
11. Export course deliverables

Word storyboard visuals are static snapshots of the authored composition, rendered through the same player as delivery packages. Motion is stopped for print, and interactive assessments are shown in their initial unanswered state. Instructional text, narration, notes, and other Word records remain editable. If document visuals cannot be prepared, ask the operator to check the document renderer; an obsolete source-slide image is not substituted. Original comparison images are excluded from delivery packages when the scene has an authored layout.

Open Export for the intended saved project. Export uses saved content, not unsaved dialog edits or pending proposals. SCORM 2004 has recorded Blackboard verification for a specific artifact; consult the compatibility checklist for the scope of testing.

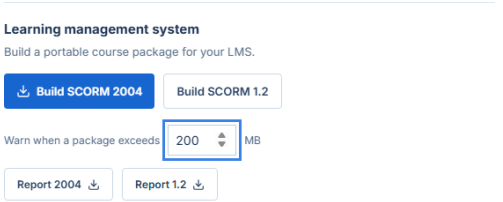
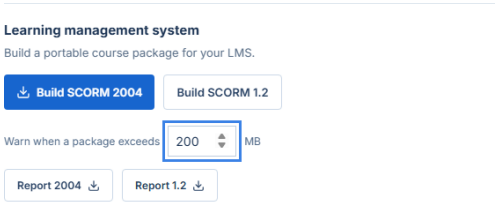
Build a SCORM package

LMS upload controls are outside Chimera and vary by platform. Verify launch, media, completion, score, and resume in the destination LMS.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Click **Export** in the top bar.	The Export course dialog opens.	
2	Choose **Build SCORM 2004** or **Build SCORM 1.2** according to the receiving LMS.	After validation and build, the browser downloads a ZIP, or shows an actionable error.	
3	Keep the ZIP intact and upload it using the receiving LMS's SCORM-package workflow.	The LMS can launch and track the package after its own acceptance checks.	

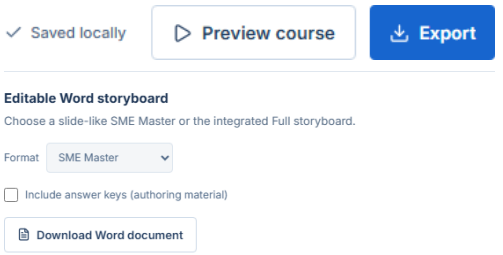
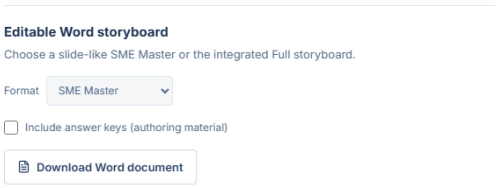
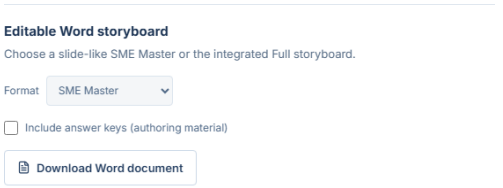
Set a package-size warning and download build reports

A report may be absent before the first build. Verify its revision/date before treating it as evidence for a newer package.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	In Export, change **Warn when a package exceeds** and leave the field to save a valid value.	The warning threshold is saved in MB.	
2	After building the corresponding profile, click **Report 2004** or **Report 1.2**.	The latest available profile build report downloads.	

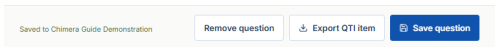
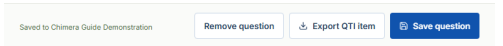
Export an editable Word storyboard

Choose **SME Master** for one editable landscape, slide-like page per scene, or **Full storyboard** for the Multimedia Instructional document with SME pages and detailed scene records. In both formats, attached image thumbnails appear in the corresponding media row with identifying, accessibility, and credit details. Edits made in Word do not synchronize back into Chimera. Word reimport is not exposed by this interface.

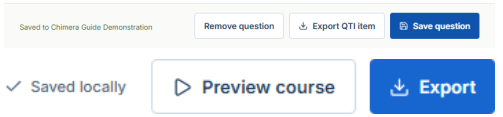
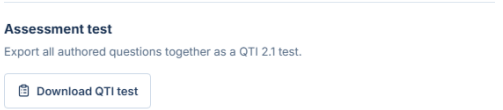
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open **Export** and locate **Editable Word storyboard**.	The Word controls are visible.	
2	Choose **SME Master** or **Full storyboard**, then decide whether to **Include answer keys (authoring material)**.	The format and answer-key policy are selected.	
3	Click **Download Word document**, then open the DOCX in Word.	Scene text and tables are editable; images remain images and interactions are documented rather than playable.	

Export one assessment as QTI

Chimera attempt/retry settings are not equivalent to settings in the receiving assessment system; verify them after import.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open the question editor, complete the question, and click **Save question**.	The current question becomes eligible for item export.	
2	Click **Export QTI item**.	A QTI 2.1 item XML file downloads.	

Export a multi-question QTI test

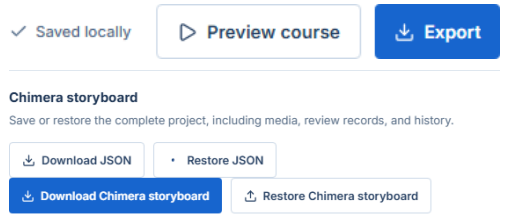
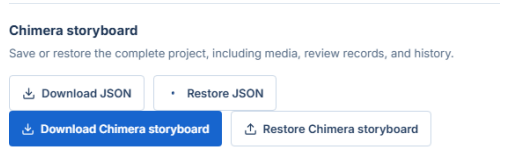
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Save questions in at least two assessment scenes, then open **Export**.	The Assessment test section becomes available.	
2	Click **Download QTI test**.	A QTI 2.1 test package containing the authored questions downloads.	

12. Back up and restore

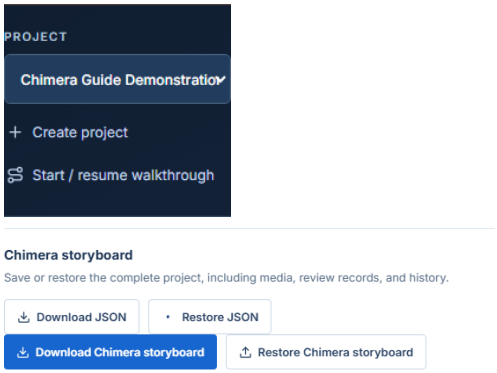
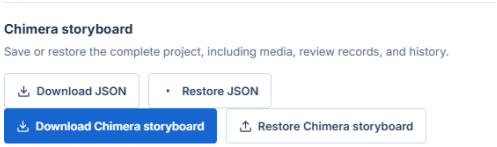
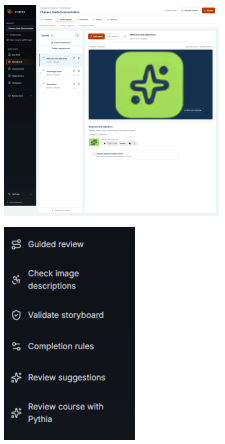
Prefer a Chimera storyboard when preserving the whole project. JSON contains storyboard data and asset references but not media binaries. Restore replaces active project content; select the target carefully and download a current Chimera storyboard first.

Download a Chimera storyboard

Build outputs/reports, media-generation job records, and the generated-candidate index are excluded by the current archive policy. Do not treat the archive as a record of every generation operation.

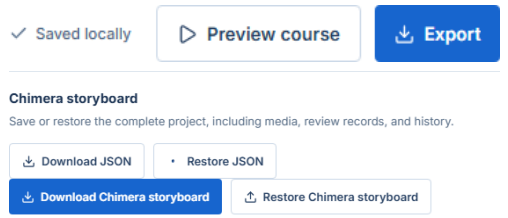
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open **Export** → **Chimera storyboard**.	Storyboard archive controls are visible.	
2	Click **Download Chimera storyboard** and retain the ZIP.	A project archive includes authored project files, resources, review records, history, and referenced templates according to the archive policy.	

Restore a Chimera storyboard

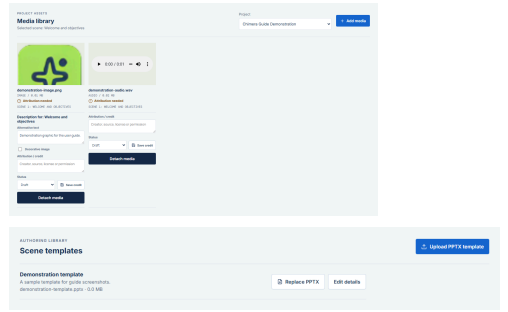
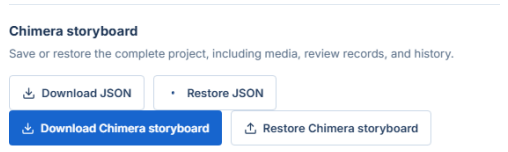
Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Select the intended destination project and download its current Chimera storyboard.	You have a separate recovery copy.	
2	Click **Restore Chimera storyboard** and select the archive; read and confirm the replacement prompt if intended.	Chimera validates and restores the archive or reports an error.	
3	Inspect scene order, media, references, comments, and validation after restoration.	The restored project can be checked before further authoring or publication.	

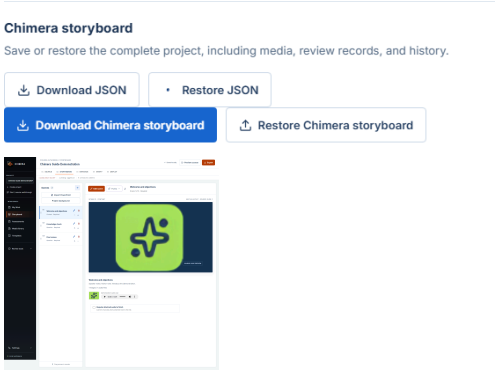
Export storyboard JSON

Use this for structured transfer of storyboard data. It is not a self-contained media backup.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Open **Export** and click **Download JSON**.	The storyboard and asset-reference data download as JSON.	

Restore storyboard JSON

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Verify that referenced assets and templates already exist in the target project.	Required dependencies are available for restoration.	
2	Open **Export** → **Restore JSON**, choose the JSON file, and read the replacement confirmation.	You can confirm or cancel replacement of the active storyboard.	

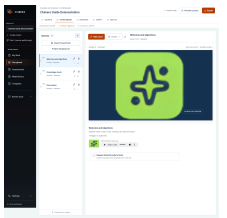
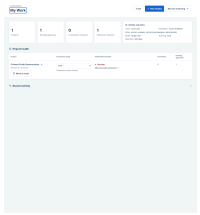
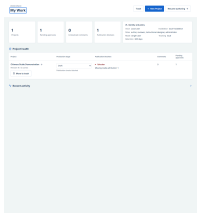
Step	Action	Result	Control image
3	Confirm if intended, then inspect the restored storyboard.	Valid JSON replaces storyboard data and preserves the previous storyboard in history; invalid input reports an error.	

13. Review project health

Inspect My Work

My Work is the opening workspace, with identity/policy shown compactly beside the summary counts. Hosted project lists are filtered by access. Production stage is a manually declared workflow label, not validation readiness or approval evidence: new projects start Draft, older projects remain Not set until classified. Authors with project-settings permission can update it without changing the storyboard revision. See My Work.

Project health uses a bounded, keyboard-scrollable area at five or more projects, with sticky desktop headings. Blocker summaries identify types and counts; expand them for individual findings. Recent activity starts collapsed and has its own scroll area when expanded.

Step	Action	Result	Control image
1	Click **My Work** in the sidebar.	My Work fills the main workspace, with sidebar navigation still available.	
2	Review counts, production stages and categorized blockers. Expand blocker findings or **Recent activity** as needed.	You can identify projects that need attention without treating readiness as approval.	
3	Select a project name/row to open that project's Storyboard, or choose **Resume authoring**.	Authoring opens for editable projects; review-only users retain review access.	

14. Work with Pythia

Pythia returns drafts for human review. Chimera remains the authoring workspace: submitting a task does not approve the course, replace scenes, or add questions. Analysis and course-review decisions record your judgment without editing content; accepted transformations and assessment proposals do change saved content.

Before you start with Pythia

1. Open the intended project with authoring access, save any open edits, and select a scene in **Storyboard**. Analysis, transformation, and assessment design start from the buttons above that scene. Course review starts from **Review tools > Review course with Pythia**.
2. Open **Settings > Pythia**. Check **Engine**, **Version**, **Capabilities**, and **Provider registry**. The required capabilities are `storyboard.analyze`, `storyboard.transform`, `assessment.design` (or the supported `assessment.blueprint` alias), and `course.review`; the reference-based enhancement form additionally requires `storyboard.enhance`. An online engine alone does not guarantee that every capability is available to your installation or account.
3. Ask the installation administrator to resolve missing capabilities, access restrictions, or an unavailable engine. This panel is diagnostic, not a provider editor. Pythia manages learning-intelligence provider/model selection; changing **AI connection** does not select a Pythia model. Usage telemetry requires administrator access and resets when the Engine restarts. Reported budget units are not a currency spending cap.
4. Confirm organisational permission to submit the selected course content. Pythia requests use saved scene text and notes, or the course inventory for course review. Do not assume that references checked in **New enhancement run** accompany these tasks. Check the reported provider: deterministic local drafts are not evidence of an external model call or instructional quality.

For a local installation, Pythia is a third service alongside the Chimera backend and frontend. From the Pythia repository root, start it in a separate terminal:

```
powershell .\.venv\Scripts\uvicorn.exe service.app:create_app --factory --host 127.0.0.1 --port 8001
```

Before starting the Chimera backend, set its Engine address in that backend terminal:

```
powershell $env:CHIMERA_PYTHIA_BASE_URL = 'http://127.0.0.1:8001'
```

Then start Chimera using the local setup instructions. If the backend is already running, restart it with the variable set, or configure the equivalent environment for its VS Code task/service. Pythia and Chimera's backend cannot both bind port 8000 on the same host. Hosted users should ask their administrator to configure the Engine address rather than starting a local copy.

Follow the PowerPoint-to-SCORM workflow

Use **Review tools > Guided review** for the Golden Path checklist and its task shortcuts. Checklist availability is not evidence that a task has been completed or approved.

1. Create a project and import the PowerPoint. Inspect extracted text, notes, scene order, and rendering warnings before asking Pythia to reason about them.
2. Analyze a source scene and inspect its evidence, uncertainty, and recommendations. Record the analysis decision in **Review suggestions**.
3. Propose and accept a transformation. Review the entire replacement sequence before acceptance, then inspect the saved scenes.
4. Add supporting media and image descriptions. Transformation media requirements are suggestions, not generated or attached assets.
5. Design an assessment. Review each native question proposal, accept only suitable items, and test them in learner preview.
6. Review the complete course. Address findings in the relevant editors and record your resolution decisions. Re-run review after content changes.
7. Preview the course, then run Production release validation and resolve blocking errors.
8. In My Work, record the human release decision by setting the production stage to **Approved**, if you have project-settings permission. This is a declared stage, not an automatic Pythia verdict or a substitute for validation.
9. Build the SCORM package and inspect its report. Verify playback, scoring, completion, and resume in the destination LMS before release.

Analyze a source scene

1. In **Storyboard**, select the source scene and click **Analyze with Pythia**. Verify the scene title and wait for the engine check.
2. Click **Analyze selected scene**. Keep the dialog open while Chimera polls the task and saves the returned draft. **Draft ready for review** is not approval.
3. Read **Findings**, **Recommendations**, **Uncertainties**, **Review questions**, and **Source references**. Check observations against the saved source; evidence links do not guarantee correctness.
4. Wait for **Saved to Review suggestions**, close the dialog, and open **Review tools > Review suggestions**. Locate the record labeled **Pythia · storyboard.analyze** and check its source revision.
5. Choose **Accept review** to mark the analysis reviewed, or **Reject** to reject the record. Neither action applies recommendations or changes the storyboard. There is no analysis **Edit values** or **Undo acceptance** control. Make any desired content changes in the scene editor or through a separately reviewed transformation.

Transform selected scenes

Before accepting: Download a Chimera storyboard if you need an accessible recovery copy. Transformation replaces selected scenes with a proposed sequence; it is not an overlay on the original slide design. Revision history is retained, but the interface has no general history-restore browser or transformation undo button.

1. Select a scene and click **Transform with Pythia**. In **Scenes to transform**, check every source scene to include. At least one is required; selected scenes are submitted in storyboard order.
2. Click **Propose transformation**. Wait for **Draft saved for review**. Compare **Current** with **Proposed sequence**, including purpose, learner content, interaction recommendations, production notes, media requirements, and assessment opportunities.
3. Close the dialog and open **Review tools > Review suggestions**. Find **Storyboard transformation**, labeled **Pythia · storyboard.transform**. Verify the selected source scenes and source revision, not just the proposal title.
4. To revise the sequence before accepting, click **Edit proposal**. This exposes **Proposed scene sequence · JSON**, not a visual scene editor. Preserve the structured fields and valid JSON; use **Cancel edit** to discard form edits. Editing alone does not apply the sequence.

5. Click **Accept transformation** to replace the selected scenes and save a new storyboard revision, or **Reject** to keep the storyboard unchanged. Acceptance applies the whole proposed sequence, not one displayed scene at a time.
6. Return to **Storyboard** and inspect the actual saved order, learner text, layouts, media, and any assessment or navigation dependencies. Implement and verify suggested interactions and media separately; a production note is not a finished interaction.

If the proposal becomes **stale** or acceptance reports that the storyboard changed, reload the current project and run a new transformation. Do not repeatedly accept the old proposal to overwrite newer work. Decide a transformation before submitting downstream assessment/review work that depends on the resulting scenes.

Design and accept an assessment

1. Select a scene and click **Design assessment**. Under **Scenes**, select the saved source scenes the assessment should cover.
2. Enter an **Objective ID** and **Statement** for every objective; use **Add objective** for additional objectives. For example, use `evacuation-route` with "Choose the safest evacuation route for a blocked exit." Remove unused objective rows rather than leaving incomplete entries.
3. Complete **Audience**, **Desired difficulty** (**Recall**, **Understanding**, **Application**, or **Analysis**), and **Completion rules**. These describe the design request; they do not save Chimera's course completion policy. Configure the actual policy separately under **Review tools > Completion rules**.
4. Click **Design assessment** and wait for the draft items to be saved. Read **Objective alignment**, **Draft items**, **Assumptions**, **Limitations**, and **Review questions**, including each item's target scene.
5. Open **Review tools > Review suggestions** and find the proposals with a **Pythia assessment...** task/artifact label. Inspect **Objective alignment**, **Blueprint assumptions and review notes**, and every **Current / Suggested** change. Verify the prompt, correct answer, feedback, scoring, fairness, and whether an existing target question would be replaced.
6. Choose **Edit values** if needed, preserving valid JSON for structured question values. Click **Accept change** to apply that proposal, or **Reject** to leave content unchanged. Draft generation alone adds no question. **Undo acceptance** is available for these native proposals only when later changes permit a safe restore.
7. Inspect the saved question through the question editor, set scoring/remediation rules, and test it in preview. Check correct and incorrect responses and completion behavior; blueprint validity is not assessment-quality approval.

Resolve stale/conflicting item proposals against the latest saved storyboard rather than forcing them through. Refresh **Review suggestions** after decisions and re-run design when the source or objectives have changed.

Review the complete course with Pythia

1. After saving scene, assessment, media, and accessibility changes, open **Review tools > Review course with Pythia**. Click **Review course with Pythia** in the dialog to submit the current course inventory.
2. Wait for the report to be saved. Use **Review run** to select a saved report by date and source revision. A report marked **source has changed** describes an earlier revision; close and reopen the dialog to start a fresh review of current content.

3. Inspect **Domain status**, each finding's category and severity, evidence references, recommendations, limitations, and the report's **Review questions**. "No findings returned" is not a certification, especially where report limitations identify missing evidence.
4. Use **Open scene**, **Open assessment**, or the other available **Open ...** controls to inspect the referenced object. Make and save the necessary correction in its editor, then return to course review and select the relevant run.
5. Enter a **Resolution note** explaining what you verified or changed, then click **Resolve**. A note is required for resolution. Use **Dismiss** for a finding you judge inapplicable; record your rationale in the note before dismissing. Use **Reopen** if a closed finding needs further attention.
6. Re-run review after content changes and inspect the new report before the release decision. Finding statuses belong to their saved review run; do not treat an older resolved report as evidence about a newer storyboard.

Resolving or dismissing a finding records a human decision only. It does not fix scene text, add alternative text, change an answer key, run production validation, set **Approved**, or publish a package. Pythia course review complements, rather than replaces, validation and learner/LMS testing.

Handle task failures and interruptions

- **Engine unavailable or capability missing:** Check **Settings > Pythia** and the address configured for the Chimera backend. Use **Refresh engine status** there, or **Retry connection** where offered in analysis. Authoring, preview, validation, and export do not require a running Pythia engine.
- **Task in progress:** Keep its dialog open until the draft is saved. **Cancel task** requests cancellation while submitted, queued, or running; inspect the returned state. Closing a dialog is not a cancellation action, and there is no general Pythia task-resume dashboard documented here.
- **Polling error:** Use **Retry polling** when offered. This resumes checking the existing task; it is not a new submission. Do not submit duplicate tasks just because a status request failed.
- **Failed or cancelled:** Address the reported cause, then use **Analyze again**, **Run transformation again**, **Run assessment design again**, or **Run course review again**, as appropriate. These create new work; they do not accept an earlier draft.
- **Access, capacity, or provider error:** Ask the administrator to check authoring permission, capability authorization, task limits, and Pythia provider health. Do not put credentials into course text or a proposal.
- **Draft saved but not visible:** Reopen **Review suggestions** for analysis, transformation, or assessment proposals. Reopen **Review course with Pythia** and select **Review run** for course reports. Confirm the active project and source revision before deciding.

Features without a documented user-facing workflow

Do not follow the implementation build plan as if every planned control already exists. The following have no complete workflow in the interface captured here:

- Unauthenticated guest review. Authenticated hosted review links have a separate documented deployment workflow.
- Arbitrary HTML, document, and embedded-application objects inside the Stage layer stack. Uploaded video can be positioned and scheduled through the scene timeline; imported media, captions/transcripts, and scene/course-wide placement also have a Media library workflow.
- Cue markers that trigger interactions or scene events, arbitrary effect keyframes, and motion paths. Current timeline cues support seeking and snapping.
- Full reference-resource classification, authority, version-management, and per-scene mapping editors.
- Word reimport or automatic synchronization of external edits.
- A general history browser and arbitrary revision restore.
- Scene timestamp/asset-anchor entry for comments.
- Generated video and a full media-generation job/cost dashboard.

See the implementation build plan for planned scope. Availability should be checked against the running application, not inferred from that plan.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to do
Projects or libraries do not load	Confirm both local services are running and inspect the displayed error.
Export questions CSV/XLSX returns Not Found	Restart the backend after installing updated code and dependencies, then refresh the frontend. A server started without reload may still serve an older route table. If it persists, check the project selection, permissions, and backend error.
Tags or learning-objective references seem missing	Scroll to the bottom of the question editor and expand **Tags and learning-objective references**. Search or choose Select; Save question keeps changes. Existing suggestions come only from saved questions in this project.
Drag-and-drop or matching has no answer items	Enter text in both lists and add items/targets as needed, then select the correct placements/matches. Answer images are not supported. In Preview, correct drag tiles settle beside the vertical targets; incorrect drops return home without using a Check answer attempt.
A control is disabled	Select a project/scene, complete required fields, or wait for the current operation. Submit run and other Pythia tasks need authoring access and their Intelligence Engine capability; media generation needs its separate provider connection. See Pythia prerequisites.
PowerPoint imports without a slide image	Check the render warning and LibreOffice availability. Inspect extracted text and media.
Media upload is rejected	Check the supported image/audio extension, file validity, and 100 MB limit.
A reference cannot be selected	Inspect its extraction status. Supply readable text when extraction is incomplete.
A proposal or save reports a revision conflict	Reload the latest project and compare changes before trying again. Preserve unsaved text separately first.

Symptom	What to do
A SCORM build is blocked	Run Production release validation and resolve the listed errors.
A QTI test button is missing	Save at least two authored assessment questions.
JSON restore reports missing references	Make required media/templates available, or use a Chimera storyboard that includes dependencies.
AI generation does not yield a candidate	Check the visible error and ask the administrator to inspect provider/job configuration. The media form has no complete job monitor.

Screenshot and verification record

The 2026-10-27 refresh manifest records 19 updated captures: workspace rail/Storyboard background location, Review tools, question bank and import review, named assessment editing/list, all seven question types, and collapsed/expanded reference and metadata controls. The searchable dropdown captures verify existing values from another saved question in the same isolated project. No user course, provider credentials, paid generation, or external submission was used. Older images below retain their original scope; this selective refresh is not a full release or LMS qualification.

Screenshots were captured from the actual local frontend and an isolated backend workspace on 2026-09-30, using a compatible headless Chromium browser, a 1500-pixel-wide viewport, and Light appearance. Images are stored in `docs/user-guide/images/` and contain demonstration data only. Proposal, generated-candidate, and enhancement-job examples were seeded locally to expose conditional controls. No paid generation or external submission was performed.

UI navigation, proposal acceptance, commenting/resolution, and sample assessment playback were exercised while capturing screens. This documentation pass does not constitute a complete regression test, Word rendering qualification, AI-provider certification, or LMS test. Screenshots should be refreshed whenever control labels or workflows change.

The 2026-10-15 Pythia workflow text was checked against the current frontend controls and integration handoffs; no new screenshots or live provider requests were made for this update. The separate Sprint 10 qualification record covers an API-level PowerPoint-to-SCORM regression using deterministic local Pythia providers. It is not a screenshot walkthrough, external-model qualification, human SME approval, or live LMS test.

Capture details and refresh instructions: manifest and maintainer instructions.

The authored-scene documentation refresh uses a separate synthetic lesson and a locally rendered synthetic PowerPoint source. Its capture manifest records the refreshed controls and hashes of the uncommitted implementation used for capture. Template application/Undo, direct background import, temporary source comparison, preview navigation, slide text, and discussion were exercised without provider traffic. This refresh does not change the dates or scope of earlier release, provider, or LMS evidence.